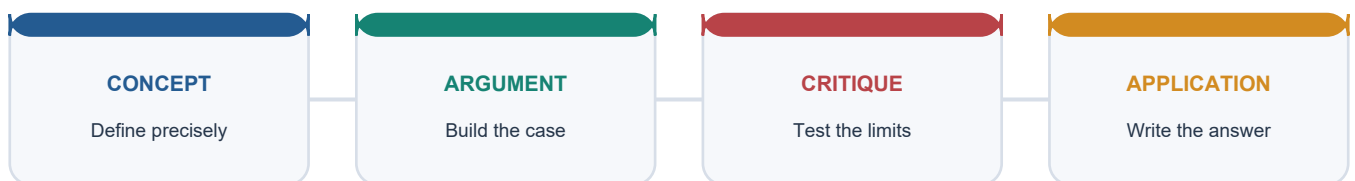


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Poverty, Inequality, Social Sector and Inclusive Growth - Complete Learning Session

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / LEARNING INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Poverty, Inequality, Social Sector and Inclusive Growth - Complete Learning Session

SOURCE, TIMELINE AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROL

Current-source cutoff: 10 September 2026.

Mandatory source order used

1. Canonical Economy and Society Basic/Core Markdown.
2. Separately labelled Optional Advanced Markdown.
3. OCR-searchable *Indian Economy* by Ramesh Singh and *Economic Survey 2025-26*.
4. Dated official MoSPI, NITI Aayog, World Bank, Union Budget/Economic Survey and social-sector ministry sources.
5. Qdrant was not required.

Evidence discipline: A poverty number is never detached from its line, PPP or price basis, survey, reference year and publisher. Expenditure, coverage, service quality and household outcome remain separate.

OFFICIAL SOURCE REGISTER

- MoSPI, HCES 2023-24 press note, 27 December 2024:
https://mospi.gov.in/sites/default/files/press_release/HCES_Press_Note_2023-24_27122024_rev.pdf
- MoSPI, HCES 2023-24 detailed results press note, 30 January 2025:
https://www.mospi.gov.in/sites/default/files/press_release/HCES_Report202324_Press_Note_30012025.pdf
- MoSPI, HCES 2022-23 methodology and fact sheet:
https://mospi.gov.in/sites/default/files/publication_reports/Factsheet_HCES_2022-23.pdf
- NITI Aayog, National MPI Progress Review 2023:
<https://www.niti.gov.in/sites/default/files/2023-08/India-National-Multidimensional-Poverty-Index-2023.pdf>
- NITI Aayog, Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06, January 2024:
https://www.niti.gov.in/sites/default/files/2024-01/MPI-22_NITI-Aayog20254.pdf
- World Bank, June 2025 update to global poverty lines:
<https://www.worldbank.org/en/news/factsheet/2025/06/05/june-2025-update-to-global-poverty-lines>
- World Bank, India Poverty and Equity Brief / PIP: <https://pip.worldbank.org/country-profiles/IND>
- PIB, Tendulkar-method poverty estimates for 2011-12: <https://pib.gov.in/newsite/PrintRelease.aspx?relid=103061>
- PIB, Rangarajan Report on Poverty, 7 August 2014: <https://pib.gov.in/newsite/printrelease.aspx?relid=108291>
- Economic Survey 2025-26: <https://www.indiabudget.gov.in/economicsurvey/>
- Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act portal: <https://nrega.nic.in/>
- Department of Food and Public Distribution, NFSA and PMGKAY:
<https://dfpd.gov.in/pradhan-mantri-garib-kalyan-anna-joyana/en>
- National Health Authority, AB-PMJAY: <https://pmjay.gov.in/>
- PIB, AB-PMJAY expansion for persons aged 70 years and above, September-October 2024:
<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2053883>
- National Social Assistance Programme portal: <https://nsap.nic.in/>
- DBT Mission, Aadhaar exception-handling OM, 19 December 2017:
https://dbtbharat.gov.in/data/om/Aadhaar_Exception_Handling_OM_19122017.pdf
- National Scholarship Portal / Ministry of Education: <https://www.education.gov.in/en/national-scholarship-portal>

ORIGIN AND TIMELINE

Date	Development	Exam boundary
1962	Planning Commission Working Group proposed a national minimum consumption approach	Early norm, not a current line
1979	Alagh Task Force formalised calorie-linked rural and urban poverty lines	Historical methodology
1993	Lakdawala Expert Group recommended state-specific price-adjusted lines	Adopted for later Planning Commission estimates
2005-09	Tendulkar Expert Group reviewed methodology and reported in 2009	Broader consumption and price treatment
2011-12	Last comparable official Planning Commission poverty ratio under Tendulkar	21.9 per cent; method and year must accompany it
2013	National Food Security Act enacted	Statutory food entitlement, not a poverty-line method
2014	Rangarajan Expert Group report released	Recommendation did not become a timeless current line
2015	JAM-DBT architecture expanded and MGNREGA social-audit systems continued	Delivery reform is not poverty measurement
2019-21	NFHS-5 observation window for NITI's 2023 MPI review	Observed survey vintage
2022-23	HCES resumed after the 2011-12 published round	Redesigned survey; comparability needs caution
January 2024	NITI discussion paper estimated MPI incidence at 11.28 per cent for 2022-23	Modelled estimate, not fresh NFHS observation
2023-24	Second consecutive HCES round	Current consumption and Gini evidence
June 2025	World Bank adopted 2021-PPP poverty lines of USD 3.00, 4.20 and 8.30	International comparison, not Indian eligibility
2025-26	Economic Survey used dated World Bank, HCES and MPI evidence	No new domestic official poverty line announced

DATED CURRENT FACT RAIL

Measure or programme	Dated fact	Qualification
Tendulkar, 2011-12	Rs 816 rural; Rs 1,000 urban monthly per capita; HCR 21.9%	Historical Planning Commission estimate
Rangarajan, 2011-12	Rs 972 rural; Rs 1,407 urban monthly per capita; HCR 29.5%	Committee recommendation released 7 August 2014
HCES 2023-24 MPCE	Without imputation: Rs 4,122 rural, Rs 6,996 urban; with imputation: Rs 4,247 and Rs 7,078	Average consumption, not a poverty line
HCES 2023-24 consumption Gini	0.237 rural; 0.284 urban	Consumption inequality; not income or wealth
World Bank, 2022-23	5.3% below USD 3.00; 23.9% below USD 4.20, 2021 PPP	World Bank estimates after June 2025 line revision
NITI national MPI	14.96% observed for NFHS-5, 2019-21; 11.28% estimated for 2022-23	Observed and estimated values must not be merged
MGNREGA	At least 100 days per rural household per financial year; work within 15 days	Demand must be registered; realised work may differ

Measure or programme	Dated fact	Qualification
NFSA/PMGKAY	PHH 5 kg/person/month; AAY 35 kg/household/month; free grain through December 2028	Grain entitlement is not full nutrition security
AB-PMJAY	Rs 5 lakh/family/year for eligible hospitalisation; 70+ expansion approved/launched Sep-Oct 2024	Insurance is not complete healthcare

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

CORE SESSION 1 - FOUNDATION - Poverty and inequality are different questions

VISUAL FIRST

POVERTY AND INEQUALITY ARE DIFFERENT QUESTIONS

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> The canonical Economy owner and World Bank methodology treat poverty incidence and distributional inequality as separate statistics.

BOUNDARY -> Always identify the welfare variable, unit, survey, year and threshold before comparing either measure.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

Poverty asks whether a person or household falls below a stated welfare threshold; inequality asks how welfare is distributed across the whole population.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: A distribution may shift upward enough to reduce poverty while becoming more unequal if upper incomes rise faster.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: threshold, distribution, welfare variable, incidence, dispersion, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** A distribution may shift upward enough to reduce poverty while becoming more unequal if upper incomes rise faster.
- **Named evidence:** The canonical Economy owner and World Bank methodology treat poverty incidence and distributional inequality as separate statistics.
- **Analysis:** Poverty asks whether a person or household falls below a stated welfare threshold; inequality asks how welfare is distributed across the whole population. A distribution may shift upward enough to reduce poverty while becoming more unequal if upper incomes rise faster.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Always identify the welfare variable, unit, survey, year and threshold before comparing either measure.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The canonical Economy owner and World Bank methodology treat poverty incidence and distributional inequality as separate statistics.
- **Analytical inference:** Poverty asks whether a person or household falls below a stated welfare threshold; inequality asks how welfare is distributed across the whole population. A distribution may shift upward enough to reduce poverty while becoming more unequal if upper incomes rise faster.
- **Qualification:** Always identify the welfare variable, unit, survey, year and threshold before comparing either measure.

PRELIMS TRAP

A fall in poverty does not logically prove a fall in inequality.

MAINS USE

Use this distinction in the introduction to prevent an answer from substituting Gini for poverty or headcount for inequality.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Poverty asks whether a person or household falls below a stated welfare threshold; inequality asks how welfare is distributed across the whole population.
- Evidence anchor: The canonical Economy owner and World Bank methodology treat poverty incidence and distributional inequality as separate statistics.
- Verdict: A distribution may shift upward enough to reduce poverty while becoming more unequal if upper incomes rise faster.

CORE SESSION 2 - FOUNDATION - Absolute and relative poverty

VISUAL FIRST

ABSOLUTE AND RELATIVE POVERTY

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> World Bank international lines are absolute real-consumption benchmarks; many high-income-country measures use relative-income thresholds.

BOUNDARY -> Absolute does not mean timeless nominal money: price and PPP conversion are required.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

Absolute poverty measures shortfall below a fixed real minimum, while relative poverty locates a person against the contemporary distribution or social standard.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: An absolute line can remain constant in real purchasing power while a relative line moves with median or average living standards.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: absolute line, relative threshold, real purchasing power, median, social standard, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** An absolute line can remain constant in real purchasing power while a relative line moves with median or average living standards.
- **Named evidence:** World Bank international lines are absolute real-consumption benchmarks; many high-income-country measures use relative-income thresholds.
- **Analysis:** Absolute poverty measures shortfall below a fixed real minimum, while relative poverty locates a person against the contemporary distribution or social standard. An absolute line can remain constant in real purchasing power while a relative line moves with median or average living standards.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Absolute does not mean timeless nominal money: price and PPP conversion are required.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** World Bank international lines are absolute real-consumption benchmarks; many high-income-country measures use relative-income thresholds.
- **Analytical inference:** Absolute poverty measures shortfall below a fixed real minimum, while relative poverty locates a person against the contemporary distribution or social standard. An absolute line can remain constant in real purchasing power while a relative line moves with median or average living standards.
- **Qualification:** Absolute does not mean timeless nominal money: price and PPP conversion are required.

PRELIMS TRAP

A nominally unchanged rupee line is not a constant real poverty line.

MAINS USE

Contrast minimum capability protection with participation in prevailing social life.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Absolute poverty measures shortfall below a fixed real minimum, while relative poverty locates a person against the contemporary distribution or social standard.

- Evidence anchor: World Bank international lines are absolute real-consumption benchmarks; many high-income-country measures use relative-income thresholds.
- Verdict: An absolute line can remain constant in real purchasing power while a relative line moves with median or average living standards.

CORE SESSION 3 - FOUNDATION - Transient and chronic poverty

VISUAL FIRST

TRANSIENT AND CHRONIC POVERTY

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> Economic Survey analysis links welfare resilience to employment, health, education and social protection rather than a single annual income observation.

BOUNDARY -> A cross-section identifies current poverty but cannot by itself establish duration; panel or repeated evidence is needed.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

Transient poverty is temporary shortfall caused by shocks; chronic poverty persists across repeated periods or generations.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Illness, crop loss, job loss or disaster can push a vulnerable household below the line, while low assets, discrimination and weak human capital can keep it there.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: transient, chronic, vulnerability, shock, persistence, panel data, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Illness, crop loss, job loss or disaster can push a vulnerable household below the line, while low assets, discrimination and weak human capital can keep it there.
- **Named evidence:** Economic Survey analysis links welfare resilience to employment, health, education and social protection rather than a single annual income observation.
- **Analysis:** Transient poverty is temporary shortfall caused by shocks; chronic poverty persists across repeated periods or generations. Illness, crop loss, job loss or disaster can push a vulnerable household below the line, while low assets, discrimination and weak human capital can keep it there.
- **Qualification / demand link:** A cross-section identifies current poverty but cannot by itself establish duration; panel or repeated evidence is needed.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** Economic Survey analysis links welfare resilience to employment, health, education and social protection rather than a single annual income observation.
- **Analytical inference:** Transient poverty is temporary shortfall caused by shocks; chronic poverty persists across repeated periods or generations. Illness, crop loss, job loss or disaster can push a vulnerable household below the line, while low assets, discrimination and weak human capital can keep it there.
- **Qualification:** A cross-section identifies current poverty but cannot by itself establish duration; panel or repeated evidence is needed.

PRELIMS TRAP

One survey observation cannot prove that a household is chronically poor.

MAINS USE

Match shock-responsive support to transient poverty and asset-capability reform to chronic poverty.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Transient poverty is temporary shortfall caused by shocks; chronic poverty persists across repeated periods or generations.
- Evidence anchor: Economic Survey analysis links welfare resilience to employment, health, education and social protection rather than a single annual income observation.

- Verdict: Illness, crop loss, job loss or disaster can push a vulnerable household below the line, while low assets, discrimination and weak human capital can keep it there.

CORE SESSION 4 - FOUNDATION - Poverty line and welfare aggregate

VISUAL FIRST

POVERTY LINE AND WELFARE AGGREGATE

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> Indian official poverty estimates historically used NSS household consumer expenditure and methodology-specific rural and urban lines.

BOUNDARY -> The line, price base, reference period, equivalence rule and survey design jointly determine the estimate.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

A poverty line is a stated threshold applied to a specified welfare aggregate, commonly per-capita consumption or income.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Surveyed household resources are converted to a comparable person-level measure and compared with a price-adjusted threshold.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: poverty line, welfare aggregate, consumption, price index, reference period, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Surveyed household resources are converted to a comparable person-level measure and compared with a price-adjusted threshold.
- **Named evidence:** Indian official poverty estimates historically used NSS household consumer expenditure and methodology-specific rural and urban lines.
- **Analysis:** A poverty line is a stated threshold applied to a specified welfare aggregate, commonly per-capita consumption or income. Surveyed household resources are converted to a comparable person-level measure and compared with a price-adjusted threshold.
- **Qualification / demand link:** The line, price base, reference period, equivalence rule and survey design jointly determine the estimate.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** Indian official poverty estimates historically used NSS household consumer expenditure and methodology-specific rural and urban lines.
- **Analytical inference:** A poverty line is a stated threshold applied to a specified welfare aggregate, commonly per-capita consumption or income. Surveyed household resources are converted to a comparable person-level measure and compared with a price-adjusted threshold.
- **Qualification:** The line, price base, reference period, equivalence rule and survey design jointly determine the estimate.

PRELIMS TRAP

A poverty line is not a universal biological constant or an income-tax exemption limit.

MAINS USE

State the measurement architecture before citing any poverty ratio.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: A poverty line is a stated threshold applied to a specified welfare aggregate, commonly per-capita consumption or income.
- Evidence anchor: Indian official poverty estimates historically used NSS household consumer expenditure and methodology-specific rural and urban lines.
- Verdict: Surveyed household resources are converted to a comparable person-level measure and compared with a price-adjusted threshold.

CORE SESSION 5 - FOUNDATION - Headcount ratio

VISUAL FIRST

HEADCOUNT RATIO

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> Planning Commission estimates under the Tendulkar method reported an all-India HCR of 21.9 per cent for 2011-12.

BOUNDARY -> Headcount is insensitive to how far below the line each poor person lies.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

The poverty headcount ratio is the share of the relevant population whose welfare measure lies below the poverty line.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: HCR equals the number of poor persons divided by the total relevant population, multiplied by 100.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: headcount ratio, incidence, numerator, denominator, poverty line, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** HCR equals the number of poor persons divided by the total relevant population, multiplied by 100.
- **Named evidence:** Planning Commission estimates under the Tendulkar method reported an all-India HCR of 21.9 per cent for 2011-12.
- **Analysis:** The poverty headcount ratio is the share of the relevant population whose welfare measure lies below the poverty line. HCR equals the number of poor persons divided by the total relevant population, multiplied by 100.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Headcount is insensitive to how far below the line each poor person lies.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** Planning Commission estimates under the Tendulkar method reported an all-India HCR of 21.9 per cent for 2011-12.
- **Analytical inference:** The poverty headcount ratio is the share of the relevant population whose welfare measure lies below the poverty line. HCR equals the number of poor persons divided by the total relevant population, multiplied by 100.
- **Qualification:** Headcount is insensitive to how far below the line each poor person lies.

PRELIMS TRAP

Giving a poor person income while they remain below the line does not change headcount.

MAINS USE

Use HCR for incidence, then add depth and severity before judging welfare intensity.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: The poverty headcount ratio is the share of the relevant population whose welfare measure lies below the poverty line.
- Evidence anchor: Planning Commission estimates under the Tendulkar method reported an all-India HCR of 21.9 per cent for 2011-12.
- Verdict: HCR equals the number of poor persons divided by the total relevant population, multiplied by 100.

CORE SESSION 6 - FOUNDATION - Poverty gap

VISUAL FIRST

POVERTY GAP

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> The Foster-Greer-Thorbecke alpha-equals-one measure captures depth that the headcount ratio misses.

BOUNDARY -> Two populations can have the same headcount but different poverty gaps.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

The poverty gap measures the average normalised shortfall of poor persons from the poverty line, counting non-poor persons as zero-gap.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: For each poor person, subtract welfare from the line, divide by the line, and average across the full population.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: poverty gap, depth, normalised shortfall, FGT, incidence, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** For each poor person, subtract welfare from the line, divide by the line, and average across the full population.
- **Named evidence:** The Foster-Greer-Thorbecke alpha-equals-one measure captures depth that the headcount ratio misses.
- **Analysis:** The poverty gap measures the average normalised shortfall of poor persons from the poverty line, counting non-poor persons as zero-gap. For each poor person, subtract welfare from the line, divide by the line, and average across the full population.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Two populations can have the same headcount but different poverty gaps.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The Foster-Greer-Thorbecke alpha-equals-one measure captures depth that the headcount ratio misses.
- **Analytical inference:** The poverty gap measures the average normalised shortfall of poor persons from the poverty line, counting non-poor persons as zero-gap. For each poor person, subtract welfare from the line, divide by the line, and average across the full population.
- **Qualification:** Two populations can have the same headcount but different poverty gaps.

PRELIMS TRAP

The poverty gap is not simply the number of people below the line.

MAINS USE

Use it to show whether transfers reduce the depth of deprivation even before households cross the line.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: The poverty gap measures the average normalised shortfall of poor persons from the poverty line, counting non-poor persons as zero-gap.
- Evidence anchor: The Foster-Greer-Thorbecke alpha-equals-one measure captures depth that the headcount ratio misses.
- Verdict: For each poor person, subtract welfare from the line, divide by the line, and average across the full population.

CORE SESSION 7 - CORE - Squared poverty gap and severity

VISUAL FIRST

SQUARED POVERTY GAP AND SEVERITY

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> The Foster-Greer-Thorbecke alpha-equals-two class is decomposable across population groups under a common line.

BOUNDARY -> Its ethical weighting is deliberate; the index is less intuitive than headcount and depends on the same line and data.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

The squared poverty gap gives greater weight to larger shortfalls and is therefore sensitive to inequality among the poor.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Squaring each normalised gap makes severe deprivation contribute disproportionately to the aggregate.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: squared gap, severity, inequality among poor, FGT alpha two, decomposability, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Squaring each normalised gap makes severe deprivation contribute disproportionately to the aggregate.
- **Named evidence:** The Foster-Greer-Thorbecke alpha-equals-two class is decomposable across population groups under a common line.
- **Analysis:** The squared poverty gap gives greater weight to larger shortfalls and is therefore sensitive to inequality among the poor. Squaring each normalised gap makes severe deprivation contribute disproportionately to the aggregate.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Its ethical weighting is deliberate; the index is less intuitive than headcount and depends on the same line and data.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The Foster-Greer-Thorbecke alpha-equals-two class is decomposable across population groups under a common line.
- **Analytical inference:** The squared poverty gap gives greater weight to larger shortfalls and is therefore sensitive to inequality among the poor. Squaring each normalised gap makes severe deprivation contribute disproportionately to the aggregate.
- **Qualification:** Its ethical weighting is deliberate; the index is less intuitive than headcount and depends on the same line and data.

PRELIMS TRAP

Severity does not mean multidimensional poverty; it is still based on the selected monetary welfare aggregate.

MAINS USE

Recommend a headcount-gap-severity dashboard rather than one poverty rate.

MINI RECAP

- **Definition:** The squared poverty gap gives greater weight to larger shortfalls and is therefore sensitive to inequality among the poor.
- **Evidence anchor:** The Foster-Greer-Thorbecke alpha-equals-two class is decomposable across population groups under a common line.
- **Verdict:** Squaring each normalised gap makes severe deprivation contribute disproportionately to the aggregate.

CORE SESSION 8 - CORE - Indian poverty-estimation chronology

VISUAL FIRST

INDIAN POVERTY-ESTIMATION CHRONOLOGY

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> The standard chronology is 1962 Working Group, Alagh 1979, Lakdawala 1993, Tendulkar 2009 and Rangarajan 2014.

BOUNDARY -> Committee report dates, reference survey years and government adoption status are distinct.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

India's official monetary-poverty methodology evolved through expert groups rather than one unchanged line.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Successive committees revised consumption norms, price adjustment and rural-urban comparability as expenditure patterns changed.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: 1962 Working Group, Alagh, Lakdawala, Tendulkar, Rangarajan, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Successive committees revised consumption norms, price adjustment and rural-urban comparability as expenditure patterns changed.
- **Named evidence:** The standard chronology is 1962 Working Group, Alagh 1979, Lakdawala 1993, Tendulkar 2009 and Rangarajan 2014.
- **Analysis:** India's official monetary-poverty methodology evolved through expert groups rather than one unchanged line. Successive committees revised consumption norms, price adjustment and rural-urban comparability as expenditure patterns changed.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Committee report dates, reference survey years and government adoption status are distinct.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The standard chronology is 1962 Working Group, Alagh 1979, Lakdawala 1993, Tendulkar 2009 and Rangarajan 2014.
- **Analytical inference:** India's official monetary-poverty methodology evolved through expert groups rather than one unchanged line. Successive committees revised consumption norms, price adjustment and rural-urban comparability as expenditure patterns changed.
- **Qualification:** Committee report dates, reference survey years and government adoption status are distinct.

PRELIMS TRAP

Rangarajan's 2014 recommendation did not automatically become a permanent current official poverty line.

MAINS USE

Use chronology to explain why poverty figures from different methods are not interchangeable.

MINI RECAP

- **Definition:** India's official monetary-poverty methodology evolved through expert groups rather than one unchanged line.
- **Evidence anchor:** The standard chronology is 1962 Working Group, Alagh 1979, Lakdawala 1993, Tendulkar 2009 and Rangarajan 2014.
- **Verdict:** Successive committees revised consumption norms, price adjustment and rural-urban comparability as expenditure patterns changed.

CORE SESSION 9 - CORE - Lakdawala methodology

VISUAL FIRST

LAKDAWALA METHODOLOGY

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> Planning Commission estimates from 1997 used the Expert Group methodology chaired by D. T. Lakdawala.

BOUNDARY -> Observed calorie intake and the expenditure corresponding to an older calorie norm can diverge as preferences and prices change.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

The Lakdawala approach retained state-specific poverty lines linked to calorie-norm expenditure baskets and updated them with price indices.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Separate rural and urban price adjustments produced state-specific thresholds and poverty estimates from NSS consumption data.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: Lakdawala, calorie norm, state-specific line, price index, NSS, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Separate rural and urban price adjustments produced state-specific thresholds and poverty estimates from NSS consumption data.
- **Named evidence:** Planning Commission estimates from 1997 used the Expert Group methodology chaired by D. T. Lakdawala.
- **Analysis:** The Lakdawala approach retained state-specific poverty lines linked to calorie-norm expenditure baskets and updated them with price indices. Separate rural and urban price adjustments produced state-specific thresholds and poverty estimates from NSS consumption data.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Observed calorie intake and the expenditure corresponding to an older calorie norm can diverge as preferences and prices change.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** Planning Commission estimates from 1997 used the Expert Group methodology chaired by D. T. Lakdawala.
- **Analytical inference:** The Lakdawala approach retained state-specific poverty lines linked to calorie-norm expenditure baskets and updated them with price indices. Separate rural and urban price adjustments produced state-specific thresholds and poverty estimates from NSS consumption data.
- **Qualification:** Observed calorie intake and the expenditure corresponding to an older calorie norm can diverge as preferences and prices change.

PRELIMS TRAP

Lakdawala did not prescribe one identical nominal line for every state.

MAINS USE

Critique the ageing basket and price-index dependence without saying nutrition ceased to matter.

MINI RECAP

- **Definition:** The Lakdawala approach retained state-specific poverty lines linked to calorie-norm expenditure baskets and updated them with price indices.
- **Evidence anchor:** Planning Commission estimates from 1997 used the Expert Group methodology chaired by D. T. Lakdawala.
- **Verdict:** Separate rural and urban price adjustments produced state-specific thresholds and poverty estimates from NSS consumption data.

CORE SESSION 10 - CORE - Tendulkar methodology and 2011-12 estimate

VISUAL FIRST

TENDULKAR METHODOLOGY AND 2011-12 ESTIMATE

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> For 2011-12 the Planning Commission reported Rs 816 rural and Rs 1,000 urban monthly per capita lines and a 21.9 per cent all-India HCR under this method.

BOUNDARY -> These are 2011-12 method-specific nominal values, not current 2026 poverty thresholds.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

The Tendulkar Committee moved away from directly anchoring poverty lines to calorie intake and used a broader consumption basket with improved price adjustment.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: It adopted a common reference urban basket logic, accounted more explicitly for private health and education spending, and used NSS consumption.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: Tendulkar 2009, 2011-12, MPCE, health, education, 21.9 per cent, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** It adopted a common reference urban basket logic, accounted more explicitly for private health and education spending, and used NSS consumption.
- **Named evidence:** For 2011-12 the Planning Commission reported Rs 816 rural and Rs 1,000 urban monthly per capita lines and a 21.9 per cent all-India HCR under this method.
- **Analysis:** The Tendulkar Committee moved away from directly anchoring poverty lines to calorie intake and used a broader consumption basket with improved price adjustment. It adopted a common reference urban basket logic, accounted more explicitly for private health and education spending, and used NSS consumption.
- **Qualification / demand link:** These are 2011-12 method-specific nominal values, not current 2026 poverty thresholds.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** For 2011-12 the Planning Commission reported Rs 816 rural and Rs 1,000 urban monthly per capita lines and a 21.9 per cent all-India HCR under this method.
- **Analytical inference:** The Tendulkar Committee moved away from directly anchoring poverty lines to calorie intake and used a broader consumption basket with improved price adjustment. It adopted a common reference urban basket logic, accounted more explicitly for private health and education spending, and used NSS consumption.
- **Qualification:** These are 2011-12 method-specific nominal values, not current 2026 poverty thresholds.

PRELIMS TRAP

Tendulkar did not define poverty solely by a fresh calorie cutoff.

MAINS USE

Cite the line and HCR only with method and year attached.

MINI RECAP

- **Definition:** The Tendulkar Committee moved away from directly anchoring poverty lines to calorie intake and used a broader consumption basket with improved price adjustment.
- **Evidence anchor:** For 2011-12 the Planning Commission reported Rs 816 rural and Rs 1,000 urban monthly per capita lines and a 21.9 per cent all-India HCR under this method.
- **Verdict:** It adopted a common reference urban basket logic, accounted more explicitly for private health and education spending, and used NSS consumption.

CORE SESSION 11 - CORE - Rangarajan methodology and status

VISUAL FIRST

RANGARAJAN METHODOLOGY AND STATUS

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> The 7 August 2014 PIB release reports Rs 972 rural and Rs 1,407 urban monthly per capita lines and a 29.5 per cent HCR for 2011-12.

BOUNDARY -> The recommendation was not adopted as a timeless successor line; current claims must remain attributed to Rangarajan and 2011-12.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

The Rangarajan Committee proposed separate normative food and non-food components and generally higher rural and urban thresholds than Tendulkar.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Its revised basket produced a larger estimated poor population for the same 2011-12 reference year.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: Rangarajan 2014, normative basket, Rs 972, Rs 1,407, 29.5 per cent, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Its revised basket produced a larger estimated poor population for the same 2011-12 reference year.
- **Named evidence:** The 7 August 2014 PIB release reports Rs 972 rural and Rs 1,407 urban monthly per capita lines and a 29.5 per cent HCR for 2011-12.
- **Analysis:** The Rangarajan Committee proposed separate normative food and non-food components and generally higher rural and urban thresholds than Tendulkar. Its revised basket produced a larger estimated poor population for the same 2011-12 reference year.
- **Qualification / demand link:** The recommendation was not adopted as a timeless successor line; current claims must remain attributed to Rangarajan and 2011-12.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The 7 August 2014 PIB release reports Rs 972 rural and Rs 1,407 urban monthly per capita lines and a 29.5 per cent HCR for 2011-12.
- **Analytical inference:** The Rangarajan Committee proposed separate normative food and non-food components and generally higher rural and urban thresholds than Tendulkar. Its revised basket produced a larger estimated poor population for the same 2011-12 reference year.
- **Qualification:** The recommendation was not adopted as a timeless successor line; current claims must remain attributed to Rangarajan and 2011-12.

PRELIMS TRAP

Higher poverty under Rangarajan does not show that living standards worsened between two dates; the method changed for the same year.

MAINS USE

Use Tendulkar-versus-Rangarajan to demonstrate methodology sensitivity.

MINI RECAP

- **Definition:** The Rangarajan Committee proposed separate normative food and non-food components and generally higher rural and urban thresholds than Tendulkar.
- **Evidence anchor:** The 7 August 2014 PIB release reports Rs 972 rural and Rs 1,407 urban monthly per capita lines and a 29.5 per cent HCR for 2011-12.
- **Verdict:** Its revised basket produced a larger estimated poor population for the same 2011-12 reference year.

CORE SESSION 12 - CORE - Current domestic poverty-line status

VISUAL FIRST

CURRENT DOMESTIC POVERTY-LINE STATUS

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> Economic Survey 2025-26 cites World Bank 2022-23 estimates and NITI multidimensional estimates rather than announcing a new domestic official line.

BOUNDARY -> Do not call a World Bank line India's statutory or officially adopted domestic poverty line.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

India presently has no single newly adopted official monetary poverty line that supersedes all committee methods for current-year measurement.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Recent debate uses HCES-based research, World Bank international lines and NITI MPI, each answering a different question.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: official status, attribution, domestic line, international estimate, methodology, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Recent debate uses HCES-based research, World Bank international lines and NITI MPI, each answering a different question.
- **Named evidence:** Economic Survey 2025-26 cites World Bank 2022-23 estimates and NITI multidimensional estimates rather than announcing a new domestic official line.
- **Analysis:** India presently has no single newly adopted official monetary poverty line that supersedes all committee methods for current-year measurement. Recent debate uses HCES-based research, World Bank international lines and NITI MPI, each answering a different question.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Do not call a World Bank line India's statutory or officially adopted domestic poverty line.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** Economic Survey 2025-26 cites World Bank 2022-23 estimates and NITI multidimensional estimates rather than announcing a new domestic official line.
- **Analytical inference:** India presently has no single newly adopted official monetary poverty line that supersedes all committee methods for current-year measurement. Recent debate uses HCES-based research, World Bank international lines and NITI MPI, each answering a different question.
- **Qualification:** Do not call a World Bank line India's statutory or officially adopted domestic poverty line.

PRELIMS TRAP

Latest available poverty estimate is not synonymous with a newly notified Indian poverty line.

MAINS USE

Open current-data answers with an attribution sentence rather than an unqualified number.

MINI RECAP

- **Definition:** India presently has no single newly adopted official monetary poverty line that supersedes all committee methods for current-year measurement.
- **Evidence anchor:** Economic Survey 2025-26 cites World Bank 2022-23 estimates and NITI multidimensional estimates rather than announcing a new domestic official line.
- **Verdict:** Recent debate uses HCES-based research, World Bank international lines and NITI MPI, each answering a different question.

CORE SESSION 13 - CORE - HCES as consumption evidence

VISUAL FIRST

HCES AS CONSUMPTION EVIDENCE

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> HCES 2022-23 was fielded from August 2022 to July 2023; HCES 2023-24 followed as a second consecutive round.

BOUNDARY -> Consumption is smoother than income for many households but can understate top-end resources and is affected by recall and imputation.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

The Household Consumption Expenditure Survey measures household consumption patterns and monthly per-capita consumption expenditure, not income or wealth.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: MoSPI samples households, records item-wise expenditure under specified reference periods and weights observations to estimate population distributions.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: HCES, MPCE, consumption, sampling, reference period, imputation, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** MoSPI samples households, records item-wise expenditure under specified reference periods and weights observations to estimate population distributions.
- **Named evidence:** HCES 2022-23 was fielded from August 2022 to July 2023; HCES 2023-24 followed as a second consecutive round.
- **Analysis:** The Household Consumption Expenditure Survey measures household consumption patterns and monthly per-capita consumption expenditure, not income or wealth. MoSPI samples households, records item-wise expenditure under specified reference periods and weights observations to estimate population distributions.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Consumption is smoother than income for many households but can understate top-end resources and is affected by recall and imputation.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** HCES 2022-23 was fielded from August 2022 to July 2023; HCES 2023-24 followed as a second consecutive round.
- **Analytical inference:** The Household Consumption Expenditure Survey measures household consumption patterns and monthly per-capita consumption expenditure, not income or wealth. MoSPI samples households, records item-wise expenditure under specified reference periods and weights observations to estimate population distributions.
- **Qualification:** Consumption is smoother than income for many households but can understate top-end resources and is affected by recall and imputation.

PRELIMS TRAP

MPCE is neither household income nor household total expenditure.

MAINS USE

Use HCES for consumption distribution while naming its survey design and limits.

MINI RECAP

- **Definition:** The Household Consumption Expenditure Survey measures household consumption patterns and monthly per-capita consumption expenditure, not income or wealth.
- **Evidence anchor:** HCES 2022-23 was fielded from August 2022 to July 2023; HCES 2023-24 followed as a second consecutive round.
- **Verdict:** MoSPI samples households, records item-wise expenditure under specified reference periods and weights observations to estimate population distributions.

CORE SESSION 14 - CORE - HCES comparability break

VISUAL FIRST

HCES COMPARABILITY BREAK

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> MoSPI's 2022-23 methodology documents a redesigned item list and collection architecture relative to NSS 2011-12.

BOUNDARY -> A long-run change from 2011-12 can reflect both welfare change and survey-design change.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

Comparability requires checking questionnaire, item list, visits, reference periods and treatment of free items before constructing a trend.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: HCES 2022-23 used multiple questionnaires and repeated visits and separately reported imputation for selected free welfare items.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: comparability, questionnaire redesign, multiple visits, free-item imputation, MMRP, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** HCES 2022-23 used multiple questionnaires and repeated visits and separately reported imputation for selected free welfare items.
- **Named evidence:** MoSPI's 2022-23 methodology documents a redesigned item list and collection architecture relative to NSS 2011-12.
- **Analysis:** Comparability requires checking questionnaire, item list, visits, reference periods and treatment of free items before constructing a trend. HCES 2022-23 used multiple questionnaires and repeated visits and separately reported imputation for selected free welfare items.
- **Qualification / demand link:** A long-run change from 2011-12 can reflect both welfare change and survey-design change.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** MoSPI's 2022-23 methodology documents a redesigned item list and collection architecture relative to NSS 2011-12.
- **Analytical inference:** Comparability requires checking questionnaire, item list, visits, reference periods and treatment of free items before constructing a trend. HCES 2022-23 used multiple questionnaires and repeated visits and separately reported imputation for selected free welfare items.
- **Qualification:** A long-run change from 2011-12 can reflect both welfare change and survey-design change.

PRELIMS TRAP

Two official surveys are not automatically directly comparable merely because both report MPCE.

MAINS USE

Place a methodology-break caveat beside any decade-long consumption claim.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Comparability requires checking questionnaire, item list, visits, reference periods and treatment of free items before constructing a trend.
- Evidence anchor: MoSPI's 2022-23 methodology documents a redesigned item list and collection architecture relative to NSS 2011-12.
- Verdict: HCES 2022-23 used multiple questionnaires and repeated visits and separately reported imputation for selected free welfare items.

CORE SESSION 15 - CORE - HCES 2023-24 consumption levels

VISUAL FIRST

HCES 2023-24 CONSUMPTION LEVELS

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> MoSPI's 27 December 2024 release reports 2023-24 MPCE without imputation at Rs 4,122 rural and Rs 6,996 urban; with imputation, Rs 4,247 and Rs 7,078.

BOUNDARY -> Average MPCE cannot reveal distribution, poverty depth or household eligibility by itself.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

Average MPCE is a period flow per person; it describes mean consumption, not a poverty threshold.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Rural and urban averages can be reported with or without imputed values for specified items received free through social welfare programmes.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: 2023-24, MPCE, rural, urban, imputation, average, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Rural and urban averages can be reported with or without imputed values for specified items received free through social welfare programmes.
- **Named evidence:** MoSPI's 27 December 2024 release reports 2023-24 MPCE without imputation at Rs 4,122 rural and Rs 6,996 urban; with imputation, Rs 4,247 and Rs 7,078.
- **Analysis:** Average MPCE is a period flow per person; it describes mean consumption, not a poverty threshold. Rural and urban averages can be reported with or without imputed values for specified items received free through social welfare programmes.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Average MPCE cannot reveal distribution, poverty depth or household eligibility by itself.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** MoSPI's 27 December 2024 release reports 2023-24 MPCE without imputation at Rs 4,122 rural and Rs 6,996 urban; with imputation, Rs 4,247 and Rs 7,078.
- **Analytical inference:** Average MPCE is a period flow per person; it describes mean consumption, not a poverty threshold. Rural and urban averages can be reported with or without imputed values for specified items received free through social welfare programmes.
- **Qualification:** Average MPCE cannot reveal distribution, poverty depth or household eligibility by itself.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not compare average MPCE directly with a method-specific poverty line without matching prices and definitions.

MAINS USE

Use current MPCE only as a consumption-level anchor, then add distributional evidence.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Average MPCE is a period flow per person; it describes mean consumption, not a poverty threshold.
- Evidence anchor: MoSPI's 27 December 2024 release reports 2023-24 MPCE without imputation at Rs 4,122 rural and Rs 6,996 urban; with imputation, Rs 4,247 and Rs 7,078.
- Verdict: Rural and urban averages can be reported with or without imputed values for specified items received free through social welfare programmes.

CORE SESSION 16 - CORE - World Bank international poverty lines

VISUAL FIRST

WORLD BANK INTERNATIONAL POVERTY LINES

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> In June 2025 the World Bank updated the lines to USD 3.00, USD 4.20 and USD 8.30 per person per day at 2021 PPP.

BOUNDARY -> They replace the earlier 2017-PPP USD 2.15, USD 3.65 and USD 6.85 lines; series across revisions are not directly interchangeable.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

International poverty lines are PPP-converted real thresholds designed for cross-country monitoring, not domestic programme eligibility.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Purchasing power parity translates currencies into comparable real consumption and the Bank periodically rebases lines when new PPPs become available.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: World Bank, June 2025, 2021 PPP, USD 3.00, USD 4.20, USD 8.30, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Purchasing power parity translates currencies into comparable real consumption and the Bank periodically rebases lines when new PPPs become available.
- **Named evidence:** In June 2025 the World Bank updated the lines to USD 3.00, USD 4.20 and USD 8.30 per person per day at 2021 PPP.
- **Analysis:** International poverty lines are PPP-converted real thresholds designed for cross-country monitoring, not domestic programme eligibility. Purchasing power parity translates currencies into comparable real consumption and the Bank periodically rebases lines when new PPPs become available.
- **Qualification / demand link:** They replace the earlier 2017-PPP USD 2.15, USD 3.65 and USD 6.85 lines; series across revisions are not directly interchangeable.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** In June 2025 the World Bank updated the lines to USD 3.00, USD 4.20 and USD 8.30 per person per day at 2021 PPP.
- **Analytical inference:** International poverty lines are PPP-converted real thresholds designed for cross-country monitoring, not domestic programme eligibility. Purchasing power parity translates currencies into comparable real consumption and the Bank periodically rebases lines when new PPPs become available.
- **Qualification:** They replace the earlier 2017-PPP USD 2.15, USD 3.65 and USD 6.85 lines; series across revisions are not directly interchangeable.

PRELIMS TRAP

PPP dollars are not converted at the market exchange rate and are not daily cash entitlements.

MAINS USE

State the line, PPP vintage, survey year and purpose every time.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: International poverty lines are PPP-converted real thresholds designed for cross-country monitoring, not domestic programme eligibility.
- Evidence anchor: In June 2025 the World Bank updated the lines to USD 3.00, USD 4.20 and USD 8.30 per person per day at 2021 PPP.
- Verdict: Purchasing power parity translates currencies into comparable real consumption and the Bank periodically rebases lines when new PPPs become available.

CORE SESSION 17 - CORE - World Bank India estimates for 2022-23

VISUAL FIRST

WORLD BANK INDIA ESTIMATES FOR 2022-23

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> World Bank's 2025 update reports India at 5.3 per cent below USD 3.00 and 23.9 per cent below USD 4.20 per person per day, both at 2021 PPP, for 2022-23.

BOUNDARY -> These are World Bank estimates, not a new Government of India domestic poverty line; they are sensitive to survey and imputation choices.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

A poverty estimate applies a named international line to a named survey distribution for a stated year.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Changing the line changes the headcount even when the underlying consumption distribution is unchanged.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: 5.3 per cent, 23.9 per cent, 2022-23, 2021 PPP, estimate, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Changing the line changes the headcount even when the underlying consumption distribution is unchanged.
- **Named evidence:** World Bank's 2025 update reports India at 5.3 per cent below USD 3.00 and 23.9 per cent below USD 4.20 per person per day, both at 2021 PPP, for 2022-23.
- **Analysis:** A poverty estimate applies a named international line to a named survey distribution for a stated year. Changing the line changes the headcount even when the underlying consumption distribution is unchanged.
- **Qualification / demand link:** These are World Bank estimates, not a new Government of India domestic poverty line; they are sensitive to survey and imputation choices.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** World Bank's 2025 update reports India at 5.3 per cent below USD 3.00 and 23.9 per cent below USD 4.20 per person per day, both at 2021 PPP, for 2022-23.
- **Analytical inference:** A poverty estimate applies a named international line to a named survey distribution for a stated year. Changing the line changes the headcount even when the underlying consumption distribution is unchanged.
- **Qualification:** These are World Bank estimates, not a new Government of India domestic poverty line; they are sensitive to survey and imputation choices.

PRELIMS TRAP

The two rates are not contradictory; they use different thresholds.

MAINS USE

Use the gap between the rates to explain vulnerability near a minimum line.

MINI RECAP

- **Definition:** A poverty estimate applies a named international line to a named survey distribution for a stated year.
- **Evidence anchor:** World Bank's 2025 update reports India at 5.3 per cent below USD 3.00 and 23.9 per cent below USD 4.20 per person per day, both at 2021 PPP, for 2022-23.
- **Verdict:** Changing the line changes the headcount even when the underlying consumption distribution is unchanged.

CORE SESSION 18 - CORE - National multidimensional poverty architecture

VISUAL FIRST

NATIONAL MULTIDIMENSIONAL POVERTY ARCHITECTURE

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> NITI Aayog's 2023 Progress Review adapts the Alkire-Foster method to 12 indicators and uses NFHS-5, 2019-21.

BOUNDARY -> National MPI differs from the 10-indicator global MPI and does not replace monetary poverty.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

India's national MPI identifies overlapping household deprivations across health, education and standard of living.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Twelve weighted indicators produce a deprivation score; a person is counted poor when the household score reaches at least one-third.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: National MPI, Alkire-Foster, 12 indicators, one-third cutoff, NFHS-5, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Twelve weighted indicators produce a deprivation score; a person is counted poor when the household score reaches at least one-third.
- **Named evidence:** NITI Aayog's 2023 Progress Review adapts the Alkire-Foster method to 12 indicators and uses NFHS-5, 2019-21.
- **Analysis:** India's national MPI identifies overlapping household deprivations across health, education and standard of living. Twelve weighted indicators produce a deprivation score; a person is counted poor when the household score reaches at least one-third.
- **Qualification / demand link:** National MPI differs from the 10-indicator global MPI and does not replace monetary poverty.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** NITI Aayog's 2023 Progress Review adapts the Alkire-Foster method to 12 indicators and uses NFHS-5, 2019-21.
- **Analytical inference:** India's national MPI identifies overlapping household deprivations across health, education and standard of living. Twelve weighted indicators produce a deprivation score; a person is counted poor when the household score reaches at least one-third.
- **Qualification:** National MPI differs from the 10-indicator global MPI and does not replace monetary poverty.

PRELIMS TRAP

An MPI-poor household and a monetary-poor household need not be the same.

MAINS USE

Use MPI as a capability diagnostic while cross-linking formal HDI/MPI treatment to Topic 2.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: India's national MPI identifies overlapping household deprivations across health, education and standard of living.
- Evidence anchor: NITI Aayog's 2023 Progress Review adapts the Alkire-Foster method to 12 indicators and uses NFHS-5, 2019-21.
- Verdict: Twelve weighted indicators produce a deprivation score; a person is counted poor when the household score reaches at least one-third.

CORE SESSION 19 - CORE - MPI headcount intensity and estimate status

VISUAL FIRST

MPI HEADCOUNT INTENSITY AND ESTIMATE STATUS

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> NITI reported observed national MPI incidence of 14.96 per cent for NFHS-5, 2019-21, and estimated 11.28 per cent for 2022-23 in its January 2024 discussion paper.

BOUNDARY -> The 2022-23 value is an estimate, not a fresh NFHS observation; indicator definitions and editions must match.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

MPI equals the multidimensional headcount ratio H multiplied by average deprivation intensity A among the poor.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: A fall may come from fewer people classified poor, lower intensity among those still poor, or both.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: MPI equals H times A , incidence, intensity, 14.96, 11.28, estimate, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** A fall may come from fewer people classified poor, lower intensity among those still poor, or both.
- **Named evidence:** NITI reported observed national MPI incidence of 14.96 per cent for NFHS-5, 2019-21, and estimated 11.28 per cent for 2022-23 in its January 2024 discussion paper.
- **Analysis:** MPI equals the multidimensional headcount ratio H multiplied by average deprivation intensity A among the poor. A fall may come from fewer people classified poor, lower intensity among those still poor, or both.
- **Qualification / demand link:** The 2022-23 value is an estimate, not a fresh NFHS observation; indicator definitions and editions must match.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** NITI reported observed national MPI incidence of 14.96 per cent for NFHS-5, 2019-21, and estimated 11.28 per cent for 2022-23 in its January 2024 discussion paper.
- **Analytical inference:** MPI equals the multidimensional headcount ratio H multiplied by average deprivation intensity A among the poor. A fall may come from fewer people classified poor, lower intensity among those still poor, or both.
- **Qualification:** The 2022-23 value is an estimate, not a fresh NFHS observation; indicator definitions and editions must match.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not describe the 11.28 per cent estimate as a 2022-23 survey observation.

MAINS USE

Separate observed benchmark, projection method and uncertainty.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: MPI equals the multidimensional headcount ratio H multiplied by average deprivation intensity A among the poor.
- Evidence anchor: NITI reported observed national MPI incidence of 14.96 per cent for NFHS-5, 2019-21, and estimated 11.28 per cent for 2022-23 in its January 2024 discussion paper.
- Verdict: A fall may come from fewer people classified poor, lower intensity among those still poor, or both.

CORE SESSION 20 - CORE - Income consumption wealth and opportunity inequality

VISUAL FIRST

INCOME CONSUMPTION WEALTH AND OPPORTUNITY INEQUALITY

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> HCES measures consumption; administrative tax or survey data may illuminate income; asset surveys and balance sheets address wealth.

BOUNDARY -> A low consumption Gini cannot establish low wealth inequality or equal opportunity.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

Income is a flow, consumption is realised spending, wealth is a stock, and opportunity inequality concerns unequal circumstances and access.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Households can smooth consumption despite volatile income, while accumulated wealth creates collateral, security and intergenerational advantage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: income flow, consumption, wealth stock, opportunity, intergenerational advantage, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Households can smooth consumption despite volatile income, while accumulated wealth creates collateral, security and intergenerational advantage.
- **Named evidence:** HCES measures consumption; administrative tax or survey data may illuminate income; asset surveys and balance sheets address wealth.
- **Analysis:** Income is a flow, consumption is realised spending, wealth is a stock, and opportunity inequality concerns unequal circumstances and access. Households can smooth consumption despite volatile income, while accumulated wealth creates collateral, security and intergenerational advantage.
- **Qualification / demand link:** A low consumption Gini cannot establish low wealth inequality or equal opportunity.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** HCES measures consumption; administrative tax or survey data may illuminate income; asset surveys and balance sheets address wealth.
- **Analytical inference:** Income is a flow, consumption is realised spending, wealth is a stock, and opportunity inequality concerns unequal circumstances and access. Households can smooth consumption despite volatile income, while accumulated wealth creates collateral, security and intergenerational advantage.
- **Qualification:** A low consumption Gini cannot establish low wealth inequality or equal opportunity.

PRELIMS TRAP

Never label a consumption-expenditure Gini as a wealth Gini.

MAINS USE

Specify which distribution is unequal and why that measure fits the question.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Income is a flow, consumption is realised spending, wealth is a stock, and opportunity inequality concerns unequal circumstances and access.
- Evidence anchor: HCES measures consumption; administrative tax or survey data may illuminate income; asset surveys and balance sheets address wealth.
- Verdict: Households can smooth consumption despite volatile income, while accumulated wealth creates collateral, security and intergenerational advantage.

CORE SESSION 21 - CORE - Lorenz curve

VISUAL FIRST

LORENZ CURVE

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> World Bank inequality methodology uses Lorenz distributions as the graphical basis for the Gini index.

BOUNDARY -> Lorenz curves can cross, preventing an unambiguous ranking by visual dominance alone.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

The Lorenz curve plots cumulative population ordered from poorest to richest against cumulative income or consumption share.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Greater bowing below the 45-degree equality line indicates greater inequality under the same welfare concept.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: cumulative population, cumulative share, equality line, Lorenz dominance, crossing, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Greater bowing below the 45-degree equality line indicates greater inequality under the same welfare concept.
- **Named evidence:** World Bank inequality methodology uses Lorenz distributions as the graphical basis for the Gini index.
- **Analysis:** The Lorenz curve plots cumulative population ordered from poorest to richest against cumulative income or consumption share. Greater bowing below the 45-degree equality line indicates greater inequality under the same welfare concept.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Lorenz curves can cross, preventing an unambiguous ranking by visual dominance alone.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** World Bank inequality methodology uses Lorenz distributions as the graphical basis for the Gini index.
- **Analytical inference:** The Lorenz curve plots cumulative population ordered from poorest to richest against cumulative income or consumption share. Greater bowing below the 45-degree equality line indicates greater inequality under the same welfare concept.
- **Qualification:** Lorenz curves can cross, preventing an unambiguous ranking by visual dominance alone.

PRELIMS TRAP

The horizontal axis is population share, not income share.

MAINS USE

Draw the axes and equality line before interpreting the curve.

MINI RECAP

- **Definition:** The Lorenz curve plots cumulative population ordered from poorest to richest against cumulative income or consumption share.
- **Evidence anchor:** World Bank inequality methodology uses Lorenz distributions as the graphical basis for the Gini index.
- **Verdict:** Greater bowing below the 45-degree equality line indicates greater inequality under the same welfare concept.

CORE SESSION 22 - CORE - Gini coefficient and HCES inequality

VISUAL FIRST

GINI COEFFICIENT AND HCES INEQUALITY

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> MoSPI reported consumption-expenditure Gini coefficients for 2023-24 of 0.237 rural and 0.284 urban, down from 0.266 and 0.314 in 2022-23.

BOUNDARY -> These are HCES consumption Ginis, not income or wealth Ginis; top-tail undercoverage and survey redesign matter.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

The Gini summarises the area between the Lorenz curve and perfect equality relative to the total area below the equality line.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: It ranges from zero equality toward one complete concentration when expressed as a coefficient.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: Gini, Lorenz area, 0.237 rural, 0.284 urban, HCES 2023-24, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** It ranges from zero equality toward one complete concentration when expressed as a coefficient.
- **Named evidence:** MoSPI reported consumption-expenditure Gini coefficients for 2023-24 of 0.237 rural and 0.284 urban, down from 0.266 and 0.314 in 2022-23.
- **Analysis:** The Gini summarises the area between the Lorenz curve and perfect equality relative to the total area below the equality line. It ranges from zero equality toward one complete concentration when expressed as a coefficient.
- **Qualification / demand link:** These are HCES consumption Ginis, not income or wealth Ginis; top-tail undercoverage and survey redesign matter.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** MoSPI reported consumption-expenditure Gini coefficients for 2023-24 of 0.237 rural and 0.284 urban, down from 0.266 and 0.314 in 2022-23.
- **Analytical inference:** The Gini summarises the area between the Lorenz curve and perfect equality relative to the total area below the equality line. It ranges from zero equality toward one complete concentration when expressed as a coefficient.
- **Qualification:** These are HCES consumption Ginis, not income or wealth Ginis; top-tail undercoverage and survey redesign matter.

PRELIMS TRAP

A lower consumption Gini does not prove that wealth concentration fell.

MAINS USE

Name welfare concept, geography and year beside every Gini.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: The Gini summarises the area between the Lorenz curve and perfect equality relative to the total area below the equality line.
- Evidence anchor: MoSPI reported consumption-expenditure Gini coefficients for 2023-24 of 0.237 rural and 0.284 urban, down from 0.266 and 0.314 in 2022-23.
- Verdict: It ranges from zero equality toward one complete concentration when expressed as a coefficient.

CORE SESSION 23 - CORE - Palma ratio quintile shares and tails

VISUAL FIRST

PALMA RATIO QUINTILE SHARES AND TAILS

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> Distributional analysis commonly pairs Gini with decile, quintile or Palma-style shares.

BOUNDARY -> Palma ignores movement within the middle 50 per cent and depends on the same data-quality constraints.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

The Palma ratio compares the top 10 per cent's income share with the bottom 40 per cent's share; quintile ratios compare selected population groups.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Tail-focused measures reveal who gains when a single Gini can conceal distributionally different changes.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: Palma ratio, top 10, bottom 40, quintile share, tails, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Tail-focused measures reveal who gains when a single Gini can conceal distributionally different changes.
- **Named evidence:** Distributional analysis commonly pairs Gini with decile, quintile or Palma-style shares.
- **Analysis:** The Palma ratio compares the top 10 per cent's income share with the bottom 40 per cent's share; quintile ratios compare selected population groups. Tail-focused measures reveal who gains when a single Gini can conceal distributionally different changes.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Palma ignores movement within the middle 50 per cent and depends on the same data-quality constraints.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** Distributional analysis commonly pairs Gini with decile, quintile or Palma-style shares.
- **Analytical inference:** The Palma ratio compares the top 10 per cent's income share with the bottom 40 per cent's share; quintile ratios compare selected population groups. Tail-focused measures reveal who gains when a single Gini can conceal distributionally different changes.
- **Qualification:** Palma ignores movement within the middle 50 per cent and depends on the same data-quality constraints.

PRELIMS TRAP

Palma is a ratio of income shares, not a ratio of population counts.

MAINS USE

Use a tail measure when the question concerns concentration or bottom-group gains.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: The Palma ratio compares the top 10 per cent's income share with the bottom 40 per cent's share; quintile ratios compare selected population groups.
- Evidence anchor: Distributional analysis commonly pairs Gini with decile, quintile or Palma-style shares.
- Verdict: Tail-focused measures reveal who gains when a single Gini can conceal distributionally different changes.

CORE SESSION 24 - CORE - Kuznets hypothesis

VISUAL FIRST

KUZNETS HYPOTHESIS

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> Kuznets presented the proposition as a historical hypothesis rather than an automatic law.

BOUNDARY -> Country experience depends on institutions, technology, asset ownership, taxation and policy; inequality need not self-correct.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

The Kuznets hypothesis proposes an inverted-U relationship in which inequality may first rise and later fall during structural transformation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Early industrial gains can concentrate in modern sectors; later diffusion, urbanisation, education and political redistribution may broaden gains.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: Kuznets curve, inverted U, structural transformation, institutions, hypothesis, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Early industrial gains can concentrate in modern sectors; later diffusion, urbanisation, education and political redistribution may broaden gains.
- **Named evidence:** Kuznets presented the proposition as a historical hypothesis rather than an automatic law.
- **Analysis:** The Kuznets hypothesis proposes an inverted-U relationship in which inequality may first rise and later fall during structural transformation. Early industrial gains can concentrate in modern sectors; later diffusion, urbanisation, education and political redistribution may broaden gains.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Country experience depends on institutions, technology, asset ownership, taxation and policy; inequality need not self-correct.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** Kuznets presented the proposition as a historical hypothesis rather than an automatic law.
- **Analytical inference:** The Kuznets hypothesis proposes an inverted-U relationship in which inequality may first rise and later fall during structural transformation. Early industrial gains can concentrate in modern sectors; later diffusion, urbanisation, education and political redistribution may broaden gains.
- **Qualification:** Country experience depends on institutions, technology, asset ownership, taxation and policy; inequality need not self-correct.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not present the Kuznets curve as a universal prediction or policy excuse.

MAINS USE

Use it as a contestable lens and identify institutions that alter the trajectory.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: The Kuznets hypothesis proposes an inverted-U relationship in which inequality may first rise and later fall during structural transformation.
- Evidence anchor: Kuznets presented the proposition as a historical hypothesis rather than an automatic law.
- Verdict: Early industrial gains can concentrate in modern sectors; later diffusion, urbanisation, education and political redistribution may broaden gains.

CORE SESSION 25 - CORE - Growth poverty inequality triangle

VISUAL FIRST

GROWTH POVERTY INEQUALITY TRIANGLE

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> Canonical Economy material identifies sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services as determinants of poverty elasticity.

BOUNDARY -> Correlation between GDP growth and poverty decline does not isolate causation or distribution.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

Poverty change depends jointly on average growth and changes in distribution.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Growth raises mean resources, but high initial inequality or concentration of gains reduces the poverty-reducing effect for a given growth rate.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: growth-poverty-inequality triangle, elasticity, initial inequality, sectoral composition, distribution, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Growth raises mean resources, but high initial inequality or concentration of gains reduces the poverty-reducing effect for a given growth rate.
- **Named evidence:** Canonical Economy material identifies sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services as determinants of poverty elasticity.
- **Analysis:** Poverty change depends jointly on average growth and changes in distribution. Growth raises mean resources, but high initial inequality or concentration of gains reduces the poverty-reducing effect for a given growth rate.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Correlation between GDP growth and poverty decline does not isolate causation or distribution.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** Canonical Economy material identifies sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services as determinants of poverty elasticity.
- **Analytical inference:** Poverty change depends jointly on average growth and changes in distribution. Growth raises mean resources, but high initial inequality or concentration of gains reduces the poverty-reducing effect for a given growth rate.
- **Qualification:** Correlation between GDP growth and poverty decline does not isolate causation or distribution.

PRELIMS TRAP

The same GDP growth rate can produce different poverty outcomes.

MAINS USE

Trace growth through jobs, wages, prices, assets and public revenue.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Poverty change depends jointly on average growth and changes in distribution.
- Evidence anchor: Canonical Economy material identifies sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services as determinants of poverty elasticity.
- Verdict: Growth raises mean resources, but high initial inequality or concentration of gains reduces the poverty-reducing effect for a given growth rate.

CORE SESSION 26 - CORE - Inclusive growth and pro-poor growth

VISUAL FIRST

INCLUSIVE GROWTH AND PRO-POOR GROWTH

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> UPSC's 2019 inclusive-growth demand explicitly joins inclusiveness with sustainability.

BOUNDARY -> A programme can be inclusive in access yet inadequate in quality, earnings or ecological durability.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

Inclusive growth broadens productive opportunity, access to services and protection; pro-poor growth specifically asks whether poor people's welfare improves absolutely or faster than others.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Absolute pro-poor growth requires poor incomes to rise; relative pro-poor growth requires their share or growth rate to improve relative to the non-poor.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: inclusive growth, absolute pro-poor, relative pro-poor, opportunity, sustainability, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Absolute pro-poor growth requires poor incomes to rise; relative pro-poor growth requires their share or growth rate to improve relative to the non-poor.
- **Named evidence:** UPSC's 2019 inclusive-growth demand explicitly joins inclusiveness with sustainability.
- **Analysis:** Inclusive growth broadens productive opportunity, access to services and protection; pro-poor growth specifically asks whether poor people's welfare improves absolutely or faster than others. Absolute pro-poor growth requires poor incomes to rise; relative pro-poor growth requires their share or growth rate to improve relative to the non-poor.
- **Qualification / demand link:** A programme can be inclusive in access yet inadequate in quality, earnings or ecological durability.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** UPSC's 2019 inclusive-growth demand explicitly joins inclusiveness with sustainability.
- **Analytical inference:** Inclusive growth broadens productive opportunity, access to services and protection; pro-poor growth specifically asks whether poor people's welfare improves absolutely or faster than others. Absolute pro-poor growth requires poor incomes to rise; relative pro-poor growth requires their share or growth rate to improve relative to the non-poor.
- **Qualification:** A programme can be inclusive in access yet inadequate in quality, earnings or ecological durability.

PRELIMS TRAP

Inclusive growth is not identical to redistribution after growth.

MAINS USE

Define the criterion before judging whether growth is pro-poor.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Inclusive growth broadens productive opportunity, access to services and protection; pro-poor growth specifically asks whether poor people's welfare improves absolutely or faster than others.
- Evidence anchor: UPSC's 2019 inclusive-growth demand explicitly joins inclusiveness with sustainability.
- Verdict: Absolute pro-poor growth requires poor incomes to rise; relative pro-poor growth requires their share or growth rate to improve relative to the non-poor.

CORE SESSION 27 - CORE - Predistribution and redistribution

VISUAL FIRST

PREDISTRIBUTION AND REDISTRIBUTION

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> Capability and human-capital approaches show why public services can change future primary income rather than merely compensate current poverty.

BOUNDARY -> The boundary is analytical: some public services both redistribute current welfare and predistribute future opportunity.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

Predistribution shapes market incomes before taxes and transfers; redistribution changes disposable resources afterward.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Education, health, land access, competition, labour institutions and asset ownership affect earning power, while progressive taxes and transfers alter post-market outcomes.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: predistribution, redistribution, market income, disposable income, assets, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Education, health, land access, competition, labour institutions and asset ownership affect earning power, while progressive taxes and transfers alter post-market outcomes.
- **Named evidence:** Capability and human-capital approaches show why public services can change future primary income rather than merely compensate current poverty.
- **Analysis:** Predistribution shapes market incomes before taxes and transfers; redistribution changes disposable resources afterward. Education, health, land access, competition, labour institutions and asset ownership affect earning power, while progressive taxes and transfers alter post-market outcomes.
- **Qualification / demand link:** The boundary is analytical: some public services both redistribute current welfare and predistribute future opportunity.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** Capability and human-capital approaches show why public services can change future primary income rather than merely compensate current poverty.
- **Analytical inference:** Predistribution shapes market incomes before taxes and transfers; redistribution changes disposable resources afterward. Education, health, land access, competition, labour institutions and asset ownership affect earning power, while progressive taxes and transfers alter post-market outcomes.
- **Qualification:** The boundary is analytical: some public services both redistribute current welfare and predistribute future opportunity.

PRELIMS TRAP

Cash transfers are not the only redistributive instrument, and skills are not merely post-market relief.

MAINS USE

Recommend a package that changes both earning capacity and immediate deprivation.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Predistribution shapes market incomes before taxes and transfers; redistribution changes disposable resources afterward.
- Evidence anchor: Capability and human-capital approaches show why public services can change future primary income rather than merely compensate current poverty.
- Verdict: Education, health, land access, competition, labour institutions and asset ownership affect earning power, while progressive taxes and transfers alter post-market outcomes.

CORE SESSION 28 - CORE - Fiscal incidence

VISUAL FIRST

FISCAL INCIDENCE

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> Budget and Economic Survey analysis distinguish allocation, actual spending and outcomes; incidence studies add who bears or benefits.

BOUNDARY -> Valuing in-kind services and indirect-tax burdens requires assumptions; average incidence may hide quality differences.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

Fiscal-incidence analysis estimates how taxes, transfers, subsidies and public services alter household welfare across the distribution.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Move from market income to disposable income after direct taxes and transfers, then to consumable or final income after indirect taxes and monetised services.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: fiscal incidence, market income, disposable income, indirect taxes, in-kind services, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Move from market income to disposable income after direct taxes and transfers, then to consumable or final income after indirect taxes and monetised services.
- **Named evidence:** Budget and Economic Survey analysis distinguish allocation, actual spending and outcomes; incidence studies add who bears or benefits.
- **Analysis:** Fiscal-incidence analysis estimates how taxes, transfers, subsidies and public services alter household welfare across the distribution. Move from market income to disposable income after direct taxes and transfers, then to consumable or final income after indirect taxes and monetised services.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Valuing in-kind services and indirect-tax burdens requires assumptions; average incidence may hide quality differences.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** Budget and Economic Survey analysis distinguish allocation, actual spending and outcomes; incidence studies add who bears or benefits.
- **Analytical inference:** Fiscal-incidence analysis estimates how taxes, transfers, subsidies and public services alter household welfare across the distribution. Move from market income to disposable income after direct taxes and transfers, then to consumable or final income after indirect taxes and monetised services.
- **Qualification:** Valuing in-kind services and indirect-tax burdens requires assumptions; average incidence may hide quality differences.

PRELIMS TRAP

A progressive spending item can be offset by regressive taxes or unequal service quality.

MAINS USE

Assess the net package rather than one subsidy or tax in isolation.

MINI RECAP

- **Definition:** Fiscal-incidence analysis estimates how taxes, transfers, subsidies and public services alter household welfare across the distribution.
- **Evidence anchor:** Budget and Economic Survey analysis distinguish allocation, actual spending and outcomes; incidence studies add who bears or benefits.
- **Verdict:** Move from market income to disposable income after direct taxes and transfers, then to consumable or final income after indirect taxes and monetised services.

CORE SESSION 29 - CORE - Progressive taxes transfers and public services

VISUAL FIRST

PROGRESSIVE TAXES TRANSFERS AND PUBLIC SERVICES

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> Health, education, nutrition and social protection are recurring social-sector channels in Union and state budgets.

BOUNDARY -> Statutory progressivity does not guarantee effective progressivity when exemptions, evasion or indirect-tax burdens differ.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

A progressive tax takes a rising effective share with ability to pay; transfers and services are progressive when lower groups receive greater relative benefit.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Revenue finances consumption protection and capability formation, while tax design affects incentives, compliance and fiscal space.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: progressive taxation, transfers, public services, effective incidence, fiscal space, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Revenue finances consumption protection and capability formation, while tax design affects incentives, compliance and fiscal space.
- **Named evidence:** Health, education, nutrition and social protection are recurring social-sector channels in Union and state budgets.
- **Analysis:** A progressive tax takes a rising effective share with ability to pay; transfers and services are progressive when lower groups receive greater relative benefit. Revenue finances consumption protection and capability formation, while tax design affects incentives, compliance and fiscal space.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Statutory progressivity does not guarantee effective progressivity when exemptions, evasion or indirect-tax burdens differ.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** Health, education, nutrition and social protection are recurring social-sector channels in Union and state budgets.
- **Analytical inference:** A progressive tax takes a rising effective share with ability to pay; transfers and services are progressive when lower groups receive greater relative benefit. Revenue finances consumption protection and capability formation, while tax design affects incentives, compliance and fiscal space.
- **Qualification:** Statutory progressivity does not guarantee effective progressivity when exemptions, evasion or indirect-tax burdens differ.

PRELIMS TRAP

Higher spending is not automatically progressive if access is captured by better-off groups.

MAINS USE

Link equity to incidence, service quality and sustainable revenue.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: A progressive tax takes a rising effective share with ability to pay; transfers and services are progressive when lower groups receive greater relative benefit.
- Evidence anchor: Health, education, nutrition and social protection are recurring social-sector channels in Union and state budgets.
- Verdict: Revenue finances consumption protection and capability formation, while tax design affects incentives, compliance and fiscal space.

CORE SESSION 30 - CORE - Capability approach and human capital

VISUAL FIRST

CAPABILITY APPROACH AND HUMAN CAPITAL

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> Amartya Sen's capability framework underpins multidimensional assessment; Economic Survey 2025-26 links education and health to mobility and inclusive growth.

BOUNDARY -> Capabilities exceed labour productivity; dignity, agency and participation have intrinsic value.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

The capability approach evaluates substantive freedoms to be healthy, educated, nourished and socially participating, while human capital emphasises productive capacities.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Public health, learning and nutrition improve agency and productivity and reduce intergenerational transmission of poverty.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: capabilities, functionings, human capital, agency, intergenerational mobility, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Public health, learning and nutrition improve agency and productivity and reduce intergenerational transmission of poverty.
- **Named evidence:** Amartya Sen's capability framework underpins multidimensional assessment; Economic Survey 2025-26 links education and health to mobility and inclusive growth.
- **Analysis:** The capability approach evaluates substantive freedoms to be healthy, educated, nourished and socially participating, while human capital emphasises productive capacities. Public health, learning and nutrition improve agency and productivity and reduce intergenerational transmission of poverty.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Capabilities exceed labour productivity; dignity, agency and participation have intrinsic value.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** Amartya Sen's capability framework underpins multidimensional assessment; Economic Survey 2025-26 links education and health to mobility and inclusive growth.
- **Analytical inference:** The capability approach evaluates substantive freedoms to be healthy, educated, nourished and socially participating, while human capital emphasises productive capacities. Public health, learning and nutrition improve agency and productivity and reduce intergenerational transmission of poverty.
- **Qualification:** Capabilities exceed labour productivity; dignity, agency and participation have intrinsic value.

PRELIMS TRAP

Capability poverty cannot be inferred completely from income alone.

MAINS USE

Combine intrinsic rights and instrumental productivity rather than reducing services to GDP inputs.

MINI RECAP

- **Definition:** The capability approach evaluates substantive freedoms to be healthy, educated, nourished and socially participating, while human capital emphasises productive capacities.
- **Evidence anchor:** Amartya Sen's capability framework underpins multidimensional assessment; Economic Survey 2025-26 links education and health to mobility and inclusive growth.
- **Verdict:** Public health, learning and nutrition improve agency and productivity and reduce intergenerational transmission of poverty.

CORE SESSION 31 - CORE - Social-sector expenditure to outcome chain

VISUAL FIRST

SOCIAL-SECTOR EXPENDITURE TO OUTCOME CHAIN

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> The 2024 GS-III question asks whether post-reform social-service expenditure aligned with inclusive growth, requiring pattern plus outcome analysis.

BOUNDARY -> More expenditure may reflect higher need or prices; outcomes also depend on governance, baseline conditions and complementary inputs.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

An allocation is budget authority, expenditure is money actually spent, output is a delivered service, and outcome is the household-level result.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Funds must be released, converted into staff and facilities, used with adequate quality, and translated into health, learning or nutrition.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: allocation, release, expenditure, output, outcome, quality, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Funds must be released, converted into staff and facilities, used with adequate quality, and translated into health, learning or nutrition.
- **Named evidence:** The 2024 GS-III question asks whether post-reform social-service expenditure aligned with inclusive growth, requiring pattern plus outcome analysis.
- **Analysis:** An allocation is budget authority, expenditure is money actually spent, output is a delivered service, and outcome is the household-level result. Funds must be released, converted into staff and facilities, used with adequate quality, and translated into health, learning or nutrition.
- **Qualification / demand link:** More expenditure may reflect higher need or prices; outcomes also depend on governance, baseline conditions and complementary inputs.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The 2024 GS-III question asks whether post-reform social-service expenditure aligned with inclusive growth, requiring pattern plus outcome analysis.
- **Analytical inference:** An allocation is budget authority, expenditure is money actually spent, output is a delivered service, and outcome is the household-level result. Funds must be released, converted into staff and facilities, used with adequate quality, and translated into health, learning or nutrition.
- **Qualification:** More expenditure may reflect higher need or prices; outcomes also depend on governance, baseline conditions and complementary inputs.

PRELIMS TRAP

Budget allocation is not proof of expenditure, access or outcome.

MAINS USE

Use the full results chain and compare states or groups.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: An allocation is budget authority, expenditure is money actually spent, output is a delivered service, and outcome is the household-level result.
- Evidence anchor: The 2024 GS-III question asks whether post-reform social-service expenditure aligned with inclusive growth, requiring pattern plus outcome analysis.
- Verdict: Funds must be released, converted into staff and facilities, used with adequate quality, and translated into health, learning or nutrition.

CORE SESSION 32 - CORE - Targeting universalism and self-selection

VISUAL FIRST

TARGETING UNIVERSALISM AND SELF-SELECTION

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> MGNREGA uses work demand and manual labour as self-selection, while NFSA uses legally allocated coverage and state identification.

BOUNDARY -> Hybrid systems can combine universal basic services with targeted cash or categorical support.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

Targeting restricts benefits by eligibility; universalism offers broad coverage; self-selection designs benefits so intended groups are more likely to participate.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Targeting saves fiscal resources but creates identification and transaction costs; universalism limits stigma and exclusion but costs more.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: targeting, universalism, means test, categorical, self-selection, stigma, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Targeting saves fiscal resources but creates identification and transaction costs; universalism limits stigma and exclusion but costs more.
- **Named evidence:** MGNREGA uses work demand and manual labour as self-selection, while NFSA uses legally allocated coverage and state identification.
- **Analysis:** Targeting restricts benefits by eligibility; universalism offers broad coverage; self-selection designs benefits so intended groups are more likely to participate. Targeting saves fiscal resources but creates identification and transaction costs; universalism limits stigma and exclusion but costs more.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Hybrid systems can combine universal basic services with targeted cash or categorical support.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** MGNREGA uses work demand and manual labour as self-selection, while NFSA uses legally allocated coverage and state identification.
- **Analytical inference:** Targeting restricts benefits by eligibility; universalism offers broad coverage; self-selection designs benefits so intended groups are more likely to participate. Targeting saves fiscal resources but creates identification and transaction costs; universalism limits stigma and exclusion but costs more.
- **Qualification:** Hybrid systems can combine universal basic services with targeted cash or categorical support.

PRELIMS TRAP

Self-selection is not absence of eligibility or administration.

MAINS USE

Judge design by error rates, adequacy, cost, incentives and political durability.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Targeting restricts benefits by eligibility; universalism offers broad coverage; self-selection designs benefits so intended groups are more likely to participate.
- Evidence anchor: MGNREGA uses work demand and manual labour as self-selection, while NFSA uses legally allocated coverage and state identification.
- Verdict: Targeting saves fiscal resources but creates identification and transaction costs; universalism limits stigma and exclusion but costs more.

CORE SESSION 33 - CORE SYNTHESIS - Exclusion and inclusion errors

VISUAL FIRST

EXCLUSION AND INCLUSION ERRORS

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> DBT Mission's 19 December 2017 Aadhaar exception-handling OM requires alternatives when authentication or connectivity fails.

BOUNDARY -> Reducing one error can increase the other; the welfare cost of exclusion may be higher for essential entitlements.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

Exclusion error denies an eligible person; inclusion error grants benefit to an ineligible person.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Outdated lists, documentation gaps, migration and authentication failure raise exclusion; weak verification and stale records raise inclusion.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: exclusion error, inclusion error, authentication, exception handling, grievance, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Outdated lists, documentation gaps, migration and authentication failure raise exclusion; weak verification and stale records raise inclusion.
- **Named evidence:** DBT Mission's 19 December 2017 Aadhaar exception-handling OM requires alternatives when authentication or connectivity fails.
- **Analysis:** Exclusion error denies an eligible person; inclusion error grants benefit to an ineligible person. Outdated lists, documentation gaps, migration and authentication failure raise exclusion; weak verification and stale records raise inclusion.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Reducing one error can increase the other; the welfare cost of exclusion may be higher for essential entitlements.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** DBT Mission's 19 December 2017 Aadhaar exception-handling OM requires alternatives when authentication or connectivity fails.
- **Analytical inference:** Exclusion error denies an eligible person; inclusion error grants benefit to an ineligible person. Outdated lists, documentation gaps, migration and authentication failure raise exclusion; weak verification and stale records raise inclusion.
- **Qualification:** Reducing one error can increase the other; the welfare cost of exclusion may be higher for essential entitlements.

PRELIMS TRAP

A clean database is not proof that every eligible person is included.

MAINS USE

Add appeals, offline alternatives, dynamic updating and audit.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Exclusion error denies an eligible person; inclusion error grants benefit to an ineligible person.
- Evidence anchor: DBT Mission's 19 December 2017 Aadhaar exception-handling OM requires alternatives when authentication or connectivity fails.
- Verdict: Outdated lists, documentation gaps, migration and authentication failure raise exclusion; weak verification and stale records raise inclusion.

CORE SESSION 34 - CORE SYNTHESIS - JAM and direct benefit transfer

VISUAL FIRST

JAM AND DIRECT BENEFIT TRANSFER

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> The DBT Mission publishes exception-handling instructions and scheme-wise transfer architecture.

BOUNDARY -> Savings claims do not by themselves establish additional welfare; cash cannot replace services with supply-side requirements.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

JAM combines Jan Dhan accounts, Aadhaar identity and mobile connectivity; DBT is a delivery mode, not a welfare objective or single scheme.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Digital identity and account transfer can reduce intermediaries, duplicates and payment delay while creating authentication, seeding and access risks.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: Jan Dhan, Aadhaar, mobile, DBT, portability, exception handling, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Digital identity and account transfer can reduce intermediaries, duplicates and payment delay while creating authentication, seeding and access risks.
- **Named evidence:** The DBT Mission publishes exception-handling instructions and scheme-wise transfer architecture.
- **Analysis:** JAM combines Jan Dhan accounts, Aadhaar identity and mobile connectivity; DBT is a delivery mode, not a welfare objective or single scheme. Digital identity and account transfer can reduce intermediaries, duplicates and payment delay while creating authentication, seeding and access risks.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Savings claims do not by themselves establish additional welfare; cash cannot replace services with supply-side requirements.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The DBT Mission publishes exception-handling instructions and scheme-wise transfer architecture.
- **Analytical inference:** JAM combines Jan Dhan accounts, Aadhaar identity and mobile connectivity; DBT is a delivery mode, not a welfare objective or single scheme. Digital identity and account transfer can reduce intermediaries, duplicates and payment delay while creating authentication, seeding and access risks.
- **Qualification:** Savings claims do not by themselves establish additional welfare; cash cannot replace services with supply-side requirements.

PRELIMS TRAP

Aadhaar authentication failure must not automatically extinguish an entitlement.

MAINS USE

Balance leakage control with last-mile inclusion, privacy, choice and grievance redress.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: JAM combines Jan Dhan accounts, Aadhaar identity and mobile connectivity; DBT is a delivery mode, not a welfare objective or single scheme.
- Evidence anchor: The DBT Mission publishes exception-handling instructions and scheme-wise transfer architecture.
- Verdict: Digital identity and account transfer can reduce intermediaries, duplicates and payment delay while creating authentication, seeding and access risks.

CORE SESSION 35 - CORE SYNTHESIS - MGNREGA rights-based employment

VISUAL FIRST

MGNREGA RIGHTS-BASED EMPLOYMENT

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> The Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act and official portal establish household entitlement, demand registration and social-audit architecture.

BOUNDARY -> Actual person-days, wage timeliness and work availability determine realised protection; it is not an urban or individual 100-day guarantee.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

MGNREGA is a demand-driven legal guarantee of at least 100 days of unskilled manual wage employment per rural household per financial year.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Adult members demand work; employment should be provided within 15 days, otherwise the state-law framework provides unemployment allowance.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: MGNREGA, 100 days, rural household, demand-driven, 15 days, social audit, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Adult members demand work; employment should be provided within 15 days, otherwise the state-law framework provides unemployment allowance.
- **Named evidence:** The Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act and official portal establish household entitlement, demand registration and social-audit architecture.
- **Analysis:** MGNREGA is a demand-driven legal guarantee of at least 100 days of unskilled manual wage employment per rural household per financial year. Adult members demand work; employment should be provided within 15 days, otherwise the state-law framework provides unemployment allowance.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Actual person-days, wage timeliness and work availability determine realised protection; it is not an urban or individual 100-day guarantee.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act and official portal establish household entitlement, demand registration and social-audit architecture.
- **Analytical inference:** MGNREGA is a demand-driven legal guarantee of at least 100 days of unskilled manual wage employment per rural household per financial year. Adult members demand work; employment should be provided within 15 days, otherwise the state-law framework provides unemployment allowance.
- **Qualification:** Actual person-days, wage timeliness and work availability determine realised protection; it is not an urban or individual 100-day guarantee.

PRELIMS TRAP

Budget allocation does not convert a statutory demand into work unless demand is recorded and met.

MAINS USE

Evaluate livelihood protection, rural wage floor, asset quality and implementation.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: MGNREGA is a demand-driven legal guarantee of at least 100 days of unskilled manual wage employment per rural household per financial year.
- Evidence anchor: The Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act and official portal establish household entitlement, demand registration and social-audit architecture.
- Verdict: Adult members demand work; employment should be provided within 15 days, otherwise the state-law framework provides unemployment allowance.

CORE SESSION 36 - CORE SYNTHESIS - NFSA food entitlement

VISUAL FIRST

NFSA FOOD ENTITLEMENT

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> Department of Food and Public Distribution records free NFSA foodgrain from 1 January 2023, extended for five years through December 2028.

BOUNDARY -> The Act's entitlement scale, identification lists, portability and nutrition outcomes are separate; cereal access is not complete nutrition security.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

The National Food Security Act 2013 creates statutory foodgrain and nutrition entitlements through identified categories and institutions.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Priority households receive 5 kg per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana households 35 kg per household per month within coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent rural and 50 per cent urban population.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: NFSA 2013, PHH, AAY, 5 kg, 35 kg, free through December 2028, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Priority households receive 5 kg per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana households 35 kg per household per month within coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent rural and 50 per cent urban population.
- **Named evidence:** Department of Food and Public Distribution records free NFSA foodgrain from 1 January 2023, extended for five years through December 2028.
- **Analysis:** The National Food Security Act 2013 creates statutory foodgrain and nutrition entitlements through identified categories and institutions. Priority households receive 5 kg per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana households 35 kg per household per month within coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent rural and 50 per cent urban population.
- **Qualification / demand link:** The Act's entitlement scale, identification lists, portability and nutrition outcomes are separate; cereal access is not complete nutrition security.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** Department of Food and Public Distribution records free NFSA foodgrain from 1 January 2023, extended for five years through December 2028.
- **Analytical inference:** The National Food Security Act 2013 creates statutory foodgrain and nutrition entitlements through identified categories and institutions. Priority households receive 5 kg per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana households 35 kg per household per month within coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent rural and 50 per cent urban population.
- **Qualification:** The Act's entitlement scale, identification lists, portability and nutrition outcomes are separate; cereal access is not complete nutrition security.

PRELIMS TRAP

The 35 kg entitlement is per AAY household, not per person.

MAINS USE

Assess legal coverage, list updating, portability, diet quality and fiscal-logistics sustainability.

MINI RECAP

- **Definition:** The National Food Security Act 2013 creates statutory foodgrain and nutrition entitlements through identified categories and institutions.
- **Evidence anchor:** Department of Food and Public Distribution records free NFSA foodgrain from 1 January 2023, extended for five years through December 2028.
- **Verdict:** Priority households receive 5 kg per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana households 35 kg per household per month within coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent rural and 50 per cent urban population.

CORE SESSION 37 - CORE SYNTHESIS - Pensions and lifecycle assistance

VISUAL FIRST

PENSIONS AND LIFECYCLE ASSISTANCE

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> NSAP includes IGNOAPS, IGNWPS, IGNDPS and the National Family Benefit Scheme; states often add their own support.

BOUNDARY -> Portal registration or nominal entitlement does not establish payment adequacy, regularity or national uniformity.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

Social assistance uses tax-financed support for eligible groups; social insurance pools contributions or specified risks.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Old age, widowhood, disability and breadwinner death can reduce earnings or raise costs, requiring predictable lifecycle protection.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: NSAP, old age, widow, disability, family benefit, social assistance, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Old age, widowhood, disability and breadwinner death can reduce earnings or raise costs, requiring predictable lifecycle protection.
- **Named evidence:** NSAP includes IGNOAPS, IGNWPS, IGNDPS and the National Family Benefit Scheme; states often add their own support.
- **Analysis:** Social assistance uses tax-financed support for eligible groups; social insurance pools contributions or specified risks. Old age, widowhood, disability and breadwinner death can reduce earnings or raise costs, requiring predictable lifecycle protection.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Portal registration or nominal entitlement does not establish payment adequacy, regularity or national uniformity.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** NSAP includes IGNOAPS, IGNWPS, IGNDPS and the National Family Benefit Scheme; states often add their own support.
- **Analytical inference:** Social assistance uses tax-financed support for eligible groups; social insurance pools contributions or specified risks. Old age, widowhood, disability and breadwinner death can reduce earnings or raise costs, requiring predictable lifecycle protection.
- **Qualification:** Portal registration or nominal entitlement does not establish payment adequacy, regularity or national uniformity.

PRELIMS TRAP

NSAP pensions are not contributory EPF pensions and should not be merged analytically.

MAINS USE

Evaluate adequacy, indexation, coverage, payment regularity and state top-ups.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Social assistance uses tax-financed support for eligible groups; social insurance pools contributions or specified risks.
- Evidence anchor: NSAP includes IGNOAPS, IGNWPS, IGNDPS and the National Family Benefit Scheme; states often add their own support.
- Verdict: Old age, widowhood, disability and breadwinner death can reduce earnings or raise costs, requiring predictable lifecycle protection.

CORE SESSION 38 - CORE SYNTHESIS - Health insurance and PM-JAY boundary

VISUAL FIRST

HEALTH INSURANCE AND PM-JAY BOUNDARY

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> The September-October 2024 expansion covers all persons aged 70 and above; already-covered families receive an additional Rs 5 lakh top-up reserved for eligible seniors.

BOUNDARY -> Coverage does not guarantee provider availability, outpatient protection, quality or zero out-of-pocket spending.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

Health insurance protects against specified financial risk; it does not itself create comprehensive public-health or primary-care capacity.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: AB-PMJAY finances eligible secondary and tertiary hospitalisation up to Rs 5 lakh per family per year through empanelled providers.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: AB-PMJAY, Rs 5 lakh, hospitalisation, age 70, top-up, empanelment, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** AB-PMJAY finances eligible secondary and tertiary hospitalisation up to Rs 5 lakh per family per year through empanelled providers.
- **Named evidence:** The September-October 2024 expansion covers all persons aged 70 and above; already-covered families receive an additional Rs 5 lakh top-up reserved for eligible seniors.
- **Analysis:** Health insurance protects against specified financial risk; it does not itself create comprehensive public-health or primary-care capacity. AB-PMJAY finances eligible secondary and tertiary hospitalisation up to Rs 5 lakh per family per year through empanelled providers.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Coverage does not guarantee provider availability, outpatient protection, quality or zero out-of-pocket spending.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The September-October 2024 expansion covers all persons aged 70 and above; already-covered families receive an additional Rs 5 lakh top-up reserved for eligible seniors.
- **Analytical inference:** Health insurance protects against specified financial risk; it does not itself create comprehensive public-health or primary-care capacity. AB-PMJAY finances eligible secondary and tertiary hospitalisation up to Rs 5 lakh per family per year through empanelled providers.
- **Qualification:** Coverage does not guarantee provider availability, outpatient protection, quality or zero out-of-pocket spending.

PRELIMS TRAP

PM-JAY is not a universal reimbursement of every medical expense.

MAINS USE

Place insurance within a continuum of primary care, public health, referral and financial protection.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Health insurance protects against specified financial risk; it does not itself create comprehensive public-health or primary-care capacity.
- Evidence anchor: The September-October 2024 expansion covers all persons aged 70 and above; already-covered families receive an additional Rs 5 lakh top-up reserved for eligible seniors.
- Verdict: AB-PMJAY finances eligible secondary and tertiary hospitalisation up to Rs 5 lakh per family per year through empanelled providers.

CORE SESSION 39 - CORE SYNTHESIS - Scholarships and education support

VISUAL FIRST

SCHOLARSHIPS AND EDUCATION SUPPORT

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> The Ministry of Education's National Scholarship Portal hosts multiple central and state schemes with scheme-specific rules.

BOUNDARY -> Enrolment or disbursement does not prove learning, completion or labour-market mobility.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

A scholarship reduces the private cost of education for a defined learner group; the National Scholarship Portal is an application and delivery platform, not one scholarship.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Fee support and maintenance assistance can reduce dropout and widen opportunity when eligibility, verification and timely payment work.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: scholarship, National Scholarship Portal, eligibility, retention, learning outcome, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Fee support and maintenance assistance can reduce dropout and widen opportunity when eligibility, verification and timely payment work.
- **Named evidence:** The Ministry of Education's National Scholarship Portal hosts multiple central and state schemes with scheme-specific rules.
- **Analysis:** A scholarship reduces the private cost of education for a defined learner group; the National Scholarship Portal is an application and delivery platform, not one scholarship. Fee support and maintenance assistance can reduce dropout and widen opportunity when eligibility, verification and timely payment work.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Enrolment or disbursement does not prove learning, completion or labour-market mobility.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The Ministry of Education's National Scholarship Portal hosts multiple central and state schemes with scheme-specific rules.
- **Analytical inference:** A scholarship reduces the private cost of education for a defined learner group; the National Scholarship Portal is an application and delivery platform, not one scholarship. Fee support and maintenance assistance can reduce dropout and widen opportunity when eligibility, verification and timely payment work.
- **Qualification:** Enrolment or disbursement does not prove learning, completion or labour-market mobility.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not assign one universal eligibility rule or amount to every NSP scheme.

MAINS USE

Evaluate access, timeliness, completion, learning and transition outcomes.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: A scholarship reduces the private cost of education for a defined learner group; the National Scholarship Portal is an application and delivery platform, not one scholarship.
- Evidence anchor: The Ministry of Education's National Scholarship Portal hosts multiple central and state schemes with scheme-specific rules.
- Verdict: Fee support and maintenance assistance can reduce dropout and widen opportunity when eligibility, verification and timely payment work.

CORE SESSION 40 - CORE SYNTHESIS - Vulnerability shocks and risk layering

VISUAL FIRST

VULNERABILITY SHOCKS AND RISK LAYERING

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> Health, climate and employment shocks recur in Economic Survey discussions of resilience and social protection.

BOUNDARY -> Poor households may have low formal insurance precisely because premiums, information and trust are constrained.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

Vulnerability is the probability of future welfare loss; poverty is an observed shortfall at a stated time.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Households manage frequent small shocks through savings and insurance, larger shocks through public support, and catastrophic covariate shocks through scalable state response.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: vulnerability, idiosyncratic shock, covariate shock, risk layering, resilience, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Households manage frequent small shocks through savings and insurance, larger shocks through public support, and catastrophic covariate shocks through scalable state response.
- **Named evidence:** Health, climate and employment shocks recur in Economic Survey discussions of resilience and social protection.
- **Analysis:** Vulnerability is the probability of future welfare loss; poverty is an observed shortfall at a stated time. Households manage frequent small shocks through savings and insurance, larger shocks through public support, and catastrophic covariate shocks through scalable state response.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Poor households may have low formal insurance precisely because premiums, information and trust are constrained.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** Health, climate and employment shocks recur in Economic Survey discussions of resilience and social protection.
- **Analytical inference:** Vulnerability is the probability of future welfare loss; poverty is an observed shortfall at a stated time. Households manage frequent small shocks through savings and insurance, larger shocks through public support, and catastrophic covariate shocks through scalable state response.
- **Qualification:** Poor households may have low formal insurance precisely because premiums, information and trust are constrained.

PRELIMS TRAP

A non-poor household today can still be highly vulnerable to poverty tomorrow.

MAINS USE

Design prevention, insurance, assistance and shock-responsive expansion as layers.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Vulnerability is the probability of future welfare loss; poverty is an observed shortfall at a stated time.
- Evidence anchor: Health, climate and employment shocks recur in Economic Survey discussions of resilience and social protection.
- Verdict: Households manage frequent small shocks through savings and insurance, larger shocks through public support, and catastrophic covariate shocks through scalable state response.

CORE SESSION 41 - CORE SYNTHESIS - Regional social gender and caste inequality

VISUAL FIRST

REGIONAL SOCIAL GENDER AND CASTE INEQUALITY

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> NITI MPI and HCES permit rural-urban and state disaggregation, while social-category and gender evidence requires dataset-specific tables.

BOUNDARY -> National averages must not be projected onto every state, caste, tribe, gender or district; causal claims need careful evidence.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

Horizontal inequality compares socially meaningful groups or places, while vertical inequality ranks individuals or households by welfare.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Unequal assets, discrimination, care burdens, remoteness and public-service quality compound one another and transmit disadvantage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: horizontal inequality, vertical inequality, caste, gender, region, intersectionality, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Unequal assets, discrimination, care burdens, remoteness and public-service quality compound one another and transmit disadvantage.
- **Named evidence:** NITI MPI and HCES permit rural-urban and state disaggregation, while social-category and gender evidence requires dataset-specific tables.
- **Analysis:** Horizontal inequality compares socially meaningful groups or places, while vertical inequality ranks individuals or households by welfare. Unequal assets, discrimination, care burdens, remoteness and public-service quality compound one another and transmit disadvantage.
- **Qualification / demand link:** National averages must not be projected onto every state, caste, tribe, gender or district; causal claims need careful evidence.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** NITI MPI and HCES permit rural-urban and state disaggregation, while social-category and gender evidence requires dataset-specific tables.
- **Analytical inference:** Horizontal inequality compares socially meaningful groups or places, while vertical inequality ranks individuals or households by welfare. Unequal assets, discrimination, care burdens, remoteness and public-service quality compound one another and transmit disadvantage.
- **Qualification:** National averages must not be projected onto every state, caste, tribe, gender or district; causal claims need careful evidence.

PRELIMS TRAP

Group disparity is not explained merely by group identity; trace assets, institutions, services and discrimination.

MAINS USE

Disaggregate the outcome and identify the mechanism instead of listing vulnerable groups.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Horizontal inequality compares socially meaningful groups or places, while vertical inequality ranks individuals or households by welfare.
- Evidence anchor: NITI MPI and HCES permit rural-urban and state disaggregation, while social-category and gender evidence requires dataset-specific tables.
- Verdict: Unequal assets, discrimination, care burdens, remoteness and public-service quality compound one another and transmit disadvantage.

CORE SESSION 42 - CORE SYNTHESIS - Policy evaluation dashboard

VISUAL FIRST

POLICY EVALUATION DASHBOARD

DEFINITION -> MECHANISM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

EVIDENCE -> MGNREGA, NFSA, NSAP, PM-JAY and scholarships expose different coverage, adequacy, quality and portability tests.

BOUNDARY -> A beneficiary count, budget outlay or portal transaction is an output, not causal proof of poverty reduction.

Visual reading: Move from definition to evidence and mechanism before reaching a qualified distributional verdict.

DEFINITION

Inclusive-policy evaluation asks whether support is adequate, reaches intended people, is progressive, delivers quality, travels with mobile citizens and remains fiscally sustainable.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Track inputs, outputs, take-up, incidence, outcomes and grievance resolution, then compare against a plausible counterfactual.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: adequacy, coverage, incidence, quality, portability, fiscal sustainability, evidence, qualification

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Track inputs, outputs, take-up, incidence, outcomes and grievance resolution, then compare against a plausible counterfactual.
- **Named evidence:** MGNREGA, NFSA, NSAP, PM-JAY and scholarships expose different coverage, adequacy, quality and portability tests.
- **Analysis:** Inclusive-policy evaluation asks whether support is adequate, reaches intended people, is progressive, delivers quality, travels with mobile citizens and remains fiscally sustainable. Track inputs, outputs, take-up, incidence, outcomes and grievance resolution, then compare against a plausible counterfactual.
- **Qualification / demand link:** A beneficiary count, budget outlay or portal transaction is an output, not causal proof of poverty reduction.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** MGNREGA, NFSA, NSAP, PM-JAY and scholarships expose different coverage, adequacy, quality and portability tests.
- **Analytical inference:** Inclusive-policy evaluation asks whether support is adequate, reaches intended people, is progressive, delivers quality, travels with mobile citizens and remains fiscally sustainable. Track inputs, outputs, take-up, incidence, outcomes and grievance resolution, then compare against a plausible counterfactual.
- **Qualification:** A beneficiary count, budget outlay or portal transaction is an output, not causal proof of poverty reduction.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not declare success from spending or enrolment alone.

MAINS USE

Conclude with a dashboard rather than a scheme catalogue.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Inclusive-policy evaluation asks whether support is adequate, reaches intended people, is progressive, delivers quality, travels with mobile citizens and remains fiscally sustainable.
- Evidence anchor: MGNREGA, NFSA, NSAP, PM-JAY and scholarships expose different coverage, adequacy, quality and portability tests.
- Verdict: Track inputs, outputs, take-up, incidence, outcomes and grievance resolution, then compare against a plausible counterfactual.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Poverty dominance and stochastic comparison

If one distribution has a lower headcount for every plausible poverty line in a stated range, it shows first-order poverty dominance. Higher-order tests incorporate depth and severity. These tools reduce dependence on one arbitrary line but still require comparable welfare data.

Decomposability and subgroup diagnosis

FGT poverty measures can be decomposed into population-weighted subgroup contributions under a common poverty line. This helps identify whether aggregate change comes from within-group progress or population composition, but subgroup labels do not themselves establish causation.

Atkinson and Generalised Entropy measures

The Atkinson index makes inequality aversion explicit; Generalised Entropy measures can be decomposed within and between groups. Their parameter choices alter sensitivity to the top or bottom, so they complement rather than automatically replace Gini.

Fiscal-incidence assumptions

Incidence estimates depend on who is assumed to bear indirect taxes, receive subsidies and value public education or health services. A monetised service benefit is not equivalent to cash and may conceal quality variation.

Social registries, portability and privacy

Dynamic social registries can improve updating and portability, but interoperable databases create privacy, consent, cybersecurity and function-creep risks. Minimum data, purpose limitation, audit trails and accessible correction are part of inclusion.

Shock-responsive financing

Triggers, contingency funds and scalable delivery rails can expand support after covariate shocks. Trigger error, local variation and fiscal pre-arrangement determine whether speed produces fair coverage.

Capability measurement limit

Observed functionings reflect both capabilities and choices under constraint. Composite indices necessarily select dimensions and weights, so deliberative legitimacy and disaggregated dashboards remain important.

Kuznets and political economy

Technology, monopoly rents, land and education inequality, tax capacity and political voice can prevent the predicted downward side of the Kuznets curve. Distribution is institutionally shaped, not a mechanical stage of growth.

Intersectionality

Gender, caste, tribe, disability, age, region and migration status can interact rather than add independently. Policy therefore needs disaggregated evidence without treating group averages as destiny.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Measurement map

- Poverty is threshold shortfall; inequality is distributional dispersion; vulnerability is future risk.
- HCR measures incidence; poverty gap measures depth; squared gap weights severe shortfalls.
- Poverty line + welfare aggregate + price/PPP basis + survey + reference period + geography are inseparable.
- Tendulkar 2011-12: Rs 816 rural, Rs 1,000 urban, HCR 21.9%; historical method-specific values.
- Rangarajan 2011-12: Rs 972 rural, Rs 1,407 urban, HCR 29.5%; 2014 recommendation, not a timeless current line.
- India has no single newly adopted current domestic monetary poverty line; attribute every estimate.
- World Bank June 2025 lines: USD 3.00, 4.20 and 8.30 at 2021 PPP.
- World Bank India 2022-23 estimates: 5.3% below USD 3.00 and 23.9% below USD 4.20.
- National MPI uses 12 indicators; $MPI = H \times A$; 14.96% is NFHS-5 observed, 11.28% for 2022-23 is estimated.

Inequality and inclusive-growth map

- Income is a flow; wealth is a stock; consumption and opportunity answer different questions.
- Lorenz plots cumulative population against cumulative welfare; Gini summarises its distance from equality.
- HCES 2023-24 consumption Gini: 0.237 rural and 0.284 urban; do not relabel as income or wealth.
- Palma = top 10% share / bottom 40% share; quintile ratios are tail-focused complements.
- Kuznets is a qualified hypothesis, not an inevitable law.
- Poverty reduction depends on growth, initial inequality, sectoral composition and access.
- Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality services, redistribution and shock protection.
- Predistribution changes market earning power; redistribution changes post-market resources.

Delivery and scheme map

- Fiscal incidence follows taxes, transfers, subsidies and in-kind services across the distribution.
- Social expenditure must pass allocation -> release -> spending -> output -> quality -> outcome.
- Targeting, universalism and self-selection involve different fiscal and error trade-offs.
- JAM is infrastructure; DBT is a delivery mode; exception handling and grievance redress prevent exclusion.
- MGNREGA: rural-household demand-driven legal guarantee of at least 100 days; 15-day work rule.
- NFSA: PHH 5 kg/person/month; AAY 35 kg/household/month; free grain through December 2028.
- NSAP assistance, PM-JAY insurance and scholarships address different lifecycle/capability risks.
- PM-JAY hospitalisation cover cannot replace primary care, public health or outpatient protection.

Examiner-ready evaluation

- Adequacy: is the benefit sufficient?
- Coverage: who is included or excluded?
- Incidence: who ultimately gains or bears cost?
- Quality: did money become a usable service?
- Portability: can migrants and mobile households access it?
- Sustainability: can financing and administrative capacity endure?
- Verdict: combine opportunity, capability, security, voice and dignity; never infer outcomes from spending or enrolment alone.